PlayStake Master Compliance Manual

Operator	[COMPANY NAME] (company no. [REG NO]), trading as PlayStake
Registered office	[REGISTERED ADDRESS]
Website	playstake.org
Licence applied for	Remote operating licence — betting intermediary (peer-to-peer wagering on skill-based games). *To be confirmed with legal advisers before submission.*
Document owner	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], Head of Compliance and Money Laundering Reporting Officer (MLRO)
Approved by	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], for and on behalf of the board
Version	0.1 — draft for licence application
Effective date	[DATE OF APPROVAL]
Next review	12 months from approval, or sooner on a material change (see section 7)

> **Draft status.** This manual and the policies it indexes were prepared from the PlayStake platform as built on 30 September 2026. They describe controls that exist in the software today, and they flag clearly where something still depends on a contract, a person or a decision. Before submission, they must be reviewed by a qualified gambling-compliance adviser or solicitor. They must also be checked against the Gambling Commission's Licence Conditions and Codes of Practice (LCCP) and guidance current at that time, as requirements are updated frequently. Paragraph references to the LCCP are given for orientation and must be confirmed.

---

1. Purpose and scope

This manual is the top-level description of how PlayStake meets the licensing objectives in section 1 of the Gambling Act 2005:

1. preventing gambling from being a source of crime or disorder, being associated with crime or disorder, or being used to support crime;
2. ensuring gambling is conducted in a fair and open way;
3. protecting children and other vulnerable persons from being harmed or exploited by gambling.

It applies to every person who works for or on behalf of PlayStake, including directors, employees, contractors and outsourced providers. It also covers every part of the PlayStake service: the website at playstake.org, the lobby and challenge system, streamed matches refereed through Kick, the demo and skill games at /play, payments and withdrawals, and all back-office tooling.

2. The business in brief

PlayStake is a peer-to-peer platform where adult customers wager against each other on the outcome of skill-based games they play themselves:

- **Opponents are other customers.** PlayStake never takes the other side of a bet. It holds both stakes in escrow and pays the winner. It earns a platform fee (a percentage of the pot) on settled matches.
- **Match types.**
  - *Lobby matches* are played in PlayStake's own games (darts, tic-tac-toe). The server decides the result.
  - *Streamed matches* are played in third-party games while both players broadcast on Kick. An independent, approved human referee watches both streams and records the result, and every referee action is written to a tamper-evident, hash-chained audit trail.
- **Money.** All money moves through a double-entry ledger with a per-match escrow account. The ledger is audited automatically every night.
- **Disputes.** Either player can dispute a result before it pays out. Payout pauses while the dispute is reviewed.

This business model shapes the risk profile, which is covered in detail in the AML Risk Assessment (Policy 07):

- **Main crime risk.** Two customers could pass money between themselves by one deliberately losing ("chip dumping").
- **Main integrity risk.** A result could be manipulated.
- **Main harm risks.** Loss-chasing and spending beyond one's means are amplified by play that is fast and competitive.

3. Governance and key people

PlayStake is a small operator at launch. One person currently holds all the key compliance roles:

Role	Holder	Responsibilities
Head of Compliance	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME]	Owns this manual and all policies. Monitors regulatory change. Reports to the board. Is the point of contact for the Gambling Commission.
Money Laundering Reporting Officer (MLRO)	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME]	Owns the AML risk assessment. Decides AML cases. Makes Suspicious Activity Reports (SARs) and Defence Against Money Laundering (DAML) requests to the NCA.
Customer Interaction / Safer Gambling Lead	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME]	Owns harm-signal review, customer interactions and the effectiveness evaluation.
Complaints Manager	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME]	Owns the complaints procedure. Issues final responses. Is the liaison with IBAS.
Personal Management Licence holders	[NAMES]	As required by the Commission for the specified management offices.

Segregation of duties. The Commission expects key functions, especially the MLRO, to be sufficiently senior, independent and resourced. While one person holds every role, PlayStake uses four compensating controls:

1. **Audit trail.** Every privileged action is written to an append-only admin audit log that the database itself protects from edits or deletion.
2. **Independent review.** An external compliance adviser, [ADVISER NAME / FIRM], reviews a sample of AML cases, harm-signal decisions and complaints every quarter.
3. **Built-in safeguards.** The software enforces the most important rules itself, so they don't depend on one person's judgement. For example:
   - age cannot be marked verified without an approved adult identity document

    - staff cannot change their own role
    - self-exclusion cannot be lifted early by anyone
    - staff can only ever lower a customer's deposit limit
4. **Separation as we grow.** Separate role holders will be appointed as the business grows, starting with the MLRO, and before monthly customer deposits exceed [THRESHOLD].

Board oversight. The board receives a compliance report every quarter covering:

- AML case volumes and outcomes, and any SARs made (numbers only)
- harm signals raised and the outcomes of interactions
- complaints: volumes, timeliness, outcomes and IBAS referrals
- ledger audit results
- any regulatory incidents or key-event notifications

4. The policies

No.	Policy	What it covers	Main controls in the platform
01	Crime Prevention and Fraud Controls	Account security, multi-accounting, collusion and match integrity, payment fraud, staff controls	2FA (required for staff), rate limits and lockouts, identity screening, head-to-head match cap, referee audit chain, double-entry ledger with nightly audit, chargeback suspension, append-only admin audit log
02	Complaints Procedure and ADR	How complaints are received, handled and escalated to IBAS	Reference numbers, immediate acknowledgement, 8-week deadline tracking with alerts, final-response letters naming IBAS
03	Self-Exclusion	Customer-requested self-exclusion and cool-off	6-month to 5-year exclusion, no early lifting, positive action plus 24-hour cooling-off to return, open activity withdrawn, marketing stopped, exclusion follows the person
04	Multi-Operator Self-Exclusion (GAMSTOP)	Participation in the national scheme	GAMSTOP checks at identity verification, login and before any deposit or stake; fails closed
05	Customer Interaction and Harm Prevention	Identify, act and evaluate	Five automated harm markers, immediate in-app interaction, staff review queue, operator limits and cool-offs, 14-day outcome evaluation, deposit-limit prompt before first deposit, reality checks
06	Age Verification	Keeping under-18s out	Date of birth and 18+ confirmation at sign-up, document KYC before any deposit, free-to-play access or gambling, under-18 closure process
07	AML Risk Assessment and Controls	Money laundering and terrorist financing	Risk assessment, KYC, transaction monitoring (chip dumping, shared IPs, deposit-and-withdraw-without-play, EDD threshold), withdrawal holds, case management, SAR process

The application's technical documents:

No.	Document	What it covers
08	System Diagram and Outsourcing Map	Every component and supplier, with commentary: payments, identity, geolocation, marketing, customer service, fraud detection, hosting

No.	Document	What it covers
09	End-to-End Customer and System Flow	Registration to gambling to payout, with the checks at each step and where the equipment is
10	Operational Model Map	Location, provider and operator of every system and activity, including key equipment
11	Testing Strategy	Test-house scope (RNG, game rules), in-house testing, CI, change control, annual security audit
12	RTS Compliance Statement and Change Register	How each applicable RTS is met, RTS 12 phase 1 and 2, and how RTS changes are tracked
13	Information Security Policy	ISO/IEC 27001:2022 control mapping for the RTS security requirements, residual risks and gaps
14	Incident Response and Key Event Reporting	Triage, response, customer and ICO notification, LCCP 15.2.1 key events within 5 working days
15	UAE (GCGRA) Certification Plan	Route to GCGRA licensing and GLI-19 / GLI-33 certification with GLI or BMM (planning draft, unverified)
16	Payment Services and Payment Methods	Payments only through PSR-authorised providers; approved methods fixed in code; provider register and onboarding checklist

Each policy states its owner, its review date, the LCCP provisions it addresses, and exactly how the platform carries it out.

5. Cross-cutting controls

These controls support every policy.

5.1 One eligibility check in front of all gambling

Every deposit, every stake, and every entry to the games (including free-to-play) passes through a single check in the platform. It fails closed and checks, in order:

1. the account is **active**, not suspended or closed
2. the customer's **age and identity are verified**
3. they are **not registered with GAMSTOP**
4. they have **no cool-off or self-exclusion in force**

Withdrawals are deliberately outside this check. A self-excluded or GAMSTOP-registered customer can always take their money out.

5.2 Records and retention

- **Protected records.** Identity documents, self-exclusions and breaks, harm signals, customer interactions, complaints, AML cases and the admin audit log are all kept when a user record is deleted. The database refuses the deletion.
- **Identity documents.** These are encrypted at rest with AES-256-GCM and decrypted only when a reviewer deliberately opens one.

- **Retention periods.** The retention schedule is set out in the Privacy Policy. Financial, dispute, referee, AML and complaint records are kept for at least 5 years after the customer relationship ends, which meets the record-keeping expectation for AML purposes. **Outstanding:** an automated purge for records past their retention period is not yet built (see section 8).

5.3 Staff access

- **Role-based access.** Admin tools are restricted to the ADMIN role, checked on the server for every request.
- **Two-factor authentication.** Staff must use 2FA to reach admin tools in production.
- **Audit log.** Every privileged change is recorded in the append-only admin audit log: who, what, when, from which IP address, and why. This includes:
  - role and KYC changes
  - account suspensions and closures
  - KYC decisions
  - dispute resolutions
  - complaint handling
  - harm-signal actions
  - AML decisions
- **Viewing the log.** Staff can read the log at /admin/audit-log.

5.4 Training

All staff complete training before gaining access to customer data or admin tools, and refresh it every year. It covers:

- this manual
- AML and the tipping-off offence
- safer gambling and customer interaction
- complaints handling
- data protection

Completion is recorded in [TRAINING RECORD LOCATION].

5.5 Alerts

The platform emails the compliance inbox, [COMPLIANCE EMAIL] (configured as `EMAIL_ADMIN`), when:

- an AML case is opened
- a harm signal is raised
- an interaction has no effect
- a complaint is two weeks from, or past, its 8-week deadline
- the nightly ledger audit fails
- the anomaly scan detects unusual patterns on PlayStake's own games

> **Important:** without `EMAIL_ADMIN` set these alerts are silently skipped. Setting it is a go-live requirement.

6. Regulatory reporting and notifications

The Head of Compliance keeps a calendar of regulatory returns and notifications, and is responsible for them:

- **Regulatory returns** to the Gambling Commission, submitted quarterly.
- **Key event notifications**, sent within the timescales in LCCP licence condition 15.2. These include:
  - a breach of the ledger's integrity
  - a significant security incident
  - a change of ADR provider
  - the appointment or departure of key people
- **Suspicious Activity Reports** to the NCA (see Policy 07). The Commission is told where the LCCP requires it.
- **Personal data breaches** reported to the ICO within 72 hours where required.

7. Review and change control

- **Scheduled review.** Every policy is reviewed at least once a year.
- **Earlier review.** A policy is also reviewed straight away after any of the following:
  - a new product, game type, payment method or technology
  - a material change in customer behaviour or risk indicators
  - a regulatory change
  - a significant incident or complaint trend
  - a finding from the quarterly independent review
- **Version control.** Changes are recorded in each document's version history and approved by the Head of Compliance and the board.
- **Code as documentation.** The platform's code is the operative description of each control. Any change to a compliance control in the code must reference the policy it implements and be reviewed by the Head of Compliance before release.

8. Outstanding items before submission

These must be done before the application is submitted, or before real-money launch as marked. Each is also noted in the relevant policy.

#	Item	Needed for	Owner
1	Complete company details, key people and PML holders throughout these documents	Application	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME]
2	Sign the ADR agreement with IBAS and confirm the referral terms. The site and emails state 6 months from the final response, which must be confirmed.	Application	Complaints Manager
3	Join GAMSTOP, then set `GAMSTOP_API_KEY` and `GAMSTOP_REQUIRED=true` in production. Also confirm field requirements: collecting a mobile number may improve match rates.	Launch	Head of Compliance
4	Appoint an electronic identity and age verification provider to supplement manual document review, including liveness and document-authenticity checks	Recommended before launch	Head of Compliance

#	Item	Needed for	Owner
5	Appoint a sanctions and PEP screening provider. Until then, check manually against the OFSI consolidated list at KYC approval and record the check in the review notes.	Launch	MLRO
6	Payments: move Stripe from test to live mode, switch to GBP, configure Stripe Radar rules and 3-D Secure, and match the payout account holder's name to the KYC legal name	Launch	Head of Compliance / engineering
7	Set `EMAIL_ADMIN` and `SENTRY_DSN` in production, and confirm alerts arrive	Launch	Engineering
8	Confirm every staff account has 2FA enabled (enforced in production)	Launch	Head of Compliance
9	Set the AML and affordability thresholds (`AML_*`, `AFFORDABILITY_REVIEW_THRESHOLD_CENTS`) to the values in the approved risk assessment, in GBP pence once currency changes	Launch	MLRO
10	Build automated data-retention purges matching the Privacy Policy	Within 3 months of launch	Engineering
11	Move rate limiting from per-process memory to Redis before running more than one web instance	Before scaling	Engineering
12	~~Add a Content-Security-Policy and frame-ancestors headers~~ Done 30 September 2026. Remaining: move to nonce-based CSP (Document 13).	Launch	Engineering
13	Update the website's licensing statement ("does not currently hold a gambling licence") to show the licence number once granted	On grant	Head of Compliance
14	Staff training programme and records	Launch	Head of Compliance
15	Engage the external compliance adviser for quarterly independent review	Launch	Board
16	Confirm the current Commission thresholds and rules on: financial vulnerability and affordability checks, consumer-set financial limit prompts, and marketing consent. Adjust the platform settings to match.	Application	Head of Compliance
17	Record the Railway region and backup location; confirm backups are enabled and test a restore	Application	Engineering
18	Decide permitted jurisdictions and add IP geolocation blocking plus a residency restriction at verification (Document 08 §6)	Launch	Head of Compliance / engineering
19	Engage a Commission-approved test house for RNG and game certification (Document 11 §3.1); confirm with the Commission the in-house/third-party split for peer-to-peer games (Higher / Lower withdrawn 30 Sep 2026 as mostly chance)	Application	Head of Compliance
20	Commission an independent penetration test; appoint the annual security auditor (first audit within 6 months of grant)	Launch / grant + 6 months	Head of Compliance
21	Close the information security gaps in Document 13 §6 (log retention, written staff security rules, supplier assurance, key rotation, `timestamptz`)	As marked there	Head of Compliance / engineering
22	Review the 12 January 2026 update to RTS 14 against Policies 03 and 04 (Document 12 §4)	Application	Head of Compliance

#	Item	Needed for	Owner
23	Build the monthly game-fairness statistical check from the game event log (Document 11 §6)	Launch	Engineering
24	Get Stripe's written approval for gambling (or appoint a gambling-approved PSP) and confirm its FCA reference number (Policy 16)	Launch	Head of Compliance
25	Block credit-funded cards on deposits (Policy 16 §7)	Launch	Head of Compliance / engineering

9. Version history

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.1	30 September 2026	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME]	First draft for licence application

Policy 01 — Crime Prevention and Fraud Controls

Operator	[COMPANY NAME], trading as PlayStake
Owner	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], Head of Compliance
Version	0.1 — draft for licence application
Review	Annually, and on any new product, payment method or significant incident
Relates to	Licensing objective 1 (keeping crime out of gambling) and objective 2 (fair and open gambling); LCCP licence condition 12 (anti-money laundering, see Policy 07) and conditions on cheating and security; Gambling Act 2005 s.42 (cheating)

> Draft for review by a compliance adviser. LCCP references to be confirmed against the current version.

1. Purpose

This policy sets out how PlayStake stops its service being used to commit crime. It covers fraud against customers or against PlayStake, cheating and match-fixing, and misuse of accounts and payments. It also sets out what we do when crime is suspected. Money laundering and terrorist financing are covered in more depth in Policy 07.

2. Our main crime and fraud risks

Risk	Why it matters for PlayStake
Collusion and match-fixing	Customers play each other. Two accounts controlled by the same person or group can fix results, either to launder money (see Policy 07) or to defraud a third party.
Result manipulation	Results decide who gets paid. A forged or tampered result would move money unfairly.
Account takeover	A stolen account could be used to stake or withdraw another person's money.
Multi-accounting	One person running several accounts to collude, evade a self-exclusion or ban, or get round limits.
Payment fraud	Stolen cards used to deposit; chargebacks after playing or withdrawing ("friendly fraud").
Insider misuse	Staff with admin access changing records, approving identities improperly, or moving money.
Ledger error or tampering	Money created or destroyed through a software fault or deliberate change.

3. Controls

3.1 Account security

- **Passwords:**
  - at least 8 characters, with an uppercase letter, a number and a special character
  - hashed with bcrypt (cost 12); never stored or logged in plain text

- **Sign-in protection:**
  - 10 failed attempts in 15 minutes from one address triggers a 30-minute lockout
  - sign-in requests are rate-limited
  - password resets are rate-limited
- **Sessions:**
  - random 256-bit tokens, stored only as hashes
  - cookies are HttpOnly, Secure and SameSite=Lax
  - sessions expire after 7 days, or after 30 minutes without use
  - every session is revoked on a password change or reset
  - closed accounts are signed out everywhere and cannot sign in again
- **Two-factor authentication (TOTP):**
  - available to every customer
  - backup codes are stored hashed
  - codes cannot be replayed
  - setting up 2FA is rate-limited
- **Email verification** is required before identity verification or any withdrawal.
- **Cross-site request forgery:** browser requests that change data are refused if they come from another site.
- **Security headers:** HSTS, X-Content-Type-Options, Referrer-Policy and Permissions-Policy. *Outstanding: Content-Security-Policy and frame-ancestors (Master Manual §8).*

3.2 One person, one account

Customers may hold only one account (Terms of Service). This is enforced as follows:

- **At identity verification:**
  - the platform compares each new submission with every other account
  - a match on the same legal name and date of birth, or an identical identity document image, opens a `SHARED_IDENTITY` case
  - approval of the new account is blocked until the case is resolved
- **Excluded or closed customers:**
  - if the matching account is self-excluded, the exclusion is applied to the new account immediately
  - staff reviewing the case will see if the other account was closed (for example, as under-18 or for fraud)
- **Shared IP addresses:** the AML scan reviews IP addresses used in the last 30 days:
  - accounts that have played each other from the same IP address open a high-severity `SHARED_IP` case
  - four or more accounts on one address open a low-severity case for review
- **Date of birth check:** the date of birth declared at sign-up is checked against the identity document. A mismatch opens a `DOB_MISMATCH` case and blocks approval.

3.3 Match integrity and cheating

Cheating is an offence under s.42 of the Gambling Act 2005. PlayStake prevents and detects it as follows:

- **No self-play.**
  - the database refuses any bet where both players are the same account
  - the lobby and challenge flows refuse it before that point

- **Head-to-head cap.** The same two customers can play each other at most **5 times in any hour**. Repeated head-to-heads are how value is passed between colluding accounts.
- **Results for PlayStake's own games:**
  - the server decides every result: it holds the game state, applies each move, and makes every random draw with a cryptographically secure generator; the browser only sends the player's move, call or aim
  - no request can declare a winner
  - every move, draw and result is written to an append-only game event log that the database protects from edits or deletion
  - settlement checks that the game session belongs to that bet and the same two players (hardened against a previously identified exploit chain)
  - a player cannot move for their opponent
  - a player who abandons a started match forfeits it, so leaving a losing position can't turn into a refund (see the Fair Play page)
- **Match Rules and Referee Code of Conduct** (published at `/match-rules`):
  - players must accept the Match Rules before sending or accepting their first stream challenge
  - referees must accept the Referee Code of Conduct when they apply, and before going available or claiming a match
  - the accepted version and time are recorded for each person, so a disputed match is judged against the rules that applied; changing a rule in substance bumps the version and everyone must accept again
  - the rules cover cheating, fixing, bots, staying live, conduct, disconnects, disputes and sanctions; the Code covers independence and conflicts, no betting or gifts, officiating live, deciding only on what the streams show, written notes and confidentiality
- **Results for streamed matches** are decided by an independent human referee:
  - referees apply, are verified (identity and age), and are approved by staff for specific games
  - a referee cannot officiate a match they are playing in, and can hold only one match at a time
  - the match can only start while both players are live on Kick with the same game declared, so the referee can watch both feeds
  - every referee action is written to an append-only, hash-chained audit trail that the database protects from edits or deletion; anyone can verify the chain for a match
  - after a decision, either player has 15 minutes to dispute it before payout
- **Disputes.** Any result can be disputed before it pays out (see Policy 02). Staff decisions on disputes are recorded in the audit log.
- **Referee quality.** Overturned referee decisions are tracked per referee. Referees with a high overturn rate are reviewed and can be suspended.
- **Anomaly detection.** A scan every 15 minutes looks for:
  - win rates above 80%
  - winning streaks of more than 10
  - average settlement under 30 seconds
  - hourly volume spikes above 3 times normal

For third-party games it can automatically reduce the game's escrow cap or freeze the developer. For PlayStake's own games it alerts staff instead, so that two colluding players cannot take the whole site offline.

- **Chip-dumping detection** (Policy 07). The same pair playing 5 or more times in 7 days, with one side winning at least 80% and receiving at least a set amount, opens a `CHIP_DUMPING` case.

3.4 Payments

- Identity and age must be verified before any deposit or withdrawal.
- **Deposits:**
  - between $5 and $1,000 per transaction
  - at most 5 deposit attempts an hour from one address
  - also limited by the customer's own deposit limits
- **Withdrawals:**
  - rate-limited
  - blocked while the account is suspended
  - held for review when an AML case is open, when the amount is large, or when money is going straight back out with little play (Policy 07)
- **Idempotency.** Every money movement uses an idempotency key, so a retried request can never pay twice.
- **Stripe webhooks** are verified by signature and de-duplicated.
- **Chargebacks.** A card dispute on a deposit immediately suspends the account and opens a high-severity `CHARGEBACK` case.
- **Outstanding (Master Manual §8):**
  - Stripe live mode with Radar fraud rules and 3-D Secure
  - GBP currency
  - matching the payout account holder's name to the verified legal name

3.5 The ledger

- **Double-entry.** All money moves through a double-entry ledger. Exactly one function is allowed to change balances. It always writes a debit and a matching credit that sum to zero, and it refuses to take any player or escrow account below zero.
- **Escrow per match.** Each match has its own escrow account, which must net to zero when the match is settled or cancelled.
- **Nightly audit.** Every night at 03:00 UTC, an automatic audit checks:
  - every account balance against its entries
  - every transaction for balance
  - that the system as a whole conserves money

  A failure alerts the compliance inbox and the error-monitoring service at the highest severity, for same-day investigation.

3.6 Staff and insider risk

Admin access is restricted as follows:

- **Access.** Admin tools are limited to the ADMIN role, checked on every request, and require two-factor authentication in production.
- **Audit trail.** Every privileged action is recorded in the append-only admin audit log, with the member of staff, time, IP address, what changed and the reason given.
- **Reasons required.** Staff must give a reason for every account-status, role and KYC change.
- **Rules staff cannot override.** The platform enforces these regardless of role:
  - staff cannot change their own role
  - staff cannot mark an identity as verified unless an approved identity document shows the customer is 18 or over
  - staff cannot lift or shorten a self-exclusion
  - staff can only lower a customer's deposit limit, never raise it
  - staff cannot reopen an account closed as under-18
- **Pre-employment checks.** Before being given admin access, staff complete [DBS / criminal record check and reference checks — to be confirmed].
- **Leavers.** Admin access is removed on the day a person leaves.

3.7 Software supply chain

- Every change is linted, type-checked and tested in CI before release.
- A malware scan runs on every push and weekly, following a 2026 supply-chain incident.
- Errors in production are reported to an error-monitoring service (Sentry).

4. When crime is suspected

1. **Contain.**
   - Suspend the account (`/admin/users`, with a reason). This stops deposits, stakes and withdrawals while still letting the customer sign in.
   - Unsettled matches can be voided with both stakes refunded where needed.
2. **Record.** Open or use an AML case (`/admin/aml`), and record the evidence and every decision on it.
3. **Decide.** The MLRO decides whether to:
   - make a Suspicious Activity Report (Policy 07)
   - report to the police or Action Fraud
   - notify the Gambling Commission as a key event
4. **Don't tip off.** Customers are not told that a report has been considered or made.
5. **Put it right.** Refund innocent third parties. Close accounts involved in fraud or cheating, and forfeit winnings obtained by cheating where the Terms allow.
6. **Learn.** Review the controls and update this policy.

5. Review

The Head of Compliance reviews this policy every year and after any significant incident. Any change to the controls described here requires an update to this document.

Version	Date	Change
0.1	30 September 2026	First draft

Policy 02 — Complaints Procedure and Alternative Dispute Resolution

Operator	[COMPANY NAME], trading as PlayStake
Owner	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], Complaints Manager
ADR provider	IBAS — Independent Betting Adjudication Service (www.ibas-uk.com). *Agreement to be signed before submission.*
Version	0.1 — draft for licence application
Review	Annually, and on any change of ADR provider (a key event to notify to the Commission)
Relates to	LCCP social responsibility code 6.1.1 (complaints and disputes) and the ADR requirements; the Alternative Dispute Resolution for Consumer Disputes Regulations 2015

> Draft for review by a compliance adviser. IBAS referral terms (including the time limit for referral) must be confirmed with IBAS when the agreement is signed.

1. Purpose

Customers must be able to complain easily, get a fair and timely answer, and take the complaint to an independent body if they are not satisfied. This policy explains how PlayStake makes that happen, and how the platform supports it.

2. What counts as a complaint

A **complaint** is any expression of dissatisfaction with PlayStake, whether spoken or written. That includes complaints about:

- the account, deposits or withdrawals
- a bet or its result
- a referee
- responsible-play tools
- how we have treated the customer
- how we handled an earlier dispute

A **result dispute** is a narrower, faster process. A player uses the dispute button on a bet to challenge a result before it pays out:

- **Timing:** within 24 hours of the result, or within 15 minutes of a referee's decision.
- **Effect:** payout pauses while staff review the game data, stream footage and referee evidence.

A customer unhappy with a dispute outcome can then make a complaint. Anything that is not a simple result challenge is handled as a complaint from the start. If in doubt, staff treat it as a complaint.

3. How customers complain

Customers can complain in two ways:

- **Online:** through the complaint form at **playstake.org/complaints**. It works whether or not the customer is signed in, so someone locked out of their account can still use it.
- **By email:** to **admin@playstake.org** (the address is shown on the complaints page, in the footer, in the Terms of Service and on every email). Staff log each email complaint into the complaints system on the day it arrives.

The /complaints page explains, in plain English:

- how to complain
- what happens next and when
- the 8-week deadline
- how to take the complaint to IBAS, and that IBAS is free and independent
- how complaints relate to result disputes
- other organisations: the Gambling Commission (which cannot resolve individual complaints), the ICO for data protection, and GamCare for support

It is linked from the site footer, from the Terms of Service (sections 09 and 17) and from every complaint email.

4. How complaints are handled

Stage	What happens	Timescale	How the platform supports it
1. Received	Complaint recorded with a unique reference (**PS-C-YYYY-NNNNNN**), a category, and any linked bet (only a bet the customer was in can be linked).	Immediately	A database sequence issues references, so two complaints can never share one.
2. Acknowledged	The customer is emailed their reference, the date by which they will get a final response, and how to reach IBAS.	Immediately	Automatic acknowledgement email.
3. Investigated	A handler reviews the complaint and relevant records, and asks the customer for more information if needed. Internal notes and messages to the customer are recorded against the complaint.	As soon as possible	Staff queue at /admin/complaints, sorted by deadline. Overdue complaints are flagged in red, and those due within 14 days in amber.
4. Final response	A written decision (upheld, partially upheld, or not upheld) with the reasons, and what will be done to put things right. The letter explains how to refer the complaint to IBAS if the customer is not satisfied.	**Within 8 weeks** of receipt	The final-response email always includes the IBAS referral wording and link. Once it is issued, the complaint is locked.

Deadline alerts. The compliance inbox receives an alert when a complaint is 2 weeks from its 8-week deadline, and again if the deadline passes without a final response.

Accountability. Every staff action on a complaint is recorded in the append-only admin audit log: the note, message, status change or final response, and who made it.

5. Handling standards

- **Be fair.** Decide on the evidence, not on who the customer is or how they complained.
- **Keep money safe.** Where a bet or balance is involved, the funds stay protected while the complaint is investigated.
- **Be plain.** Write in clear English. Explain the reasons, not just the outcome.
- **Put it right.** If we got something wrong, correct it (including any money owed) and say what we will change.
- **Watch for harm.** If a complaint suggests the customer may be experiencing gambling harm, refer it to the Safer Gambling Lead and record a customer interaction (Policy 05).
- **Watch for crime.** If a complaint reveals suspected fraud or money laundering, refer it to the MLRO. Do not tip off the customer (Policy 07).

6. Alternative Dispute Resolution — IBAS

PlayStake's ADR provider is **IBAS**, the Independent Betting Adjudication Service. It is approved by the Gambling Commission as an ADR entity for gambling disputes.

- **When customers can refer:** once they have our final response and are not satisfied, or if we have not given a final response within 8 weeks.
- **Cost:** IBAS is free for customers.
- **Time limit:** customers should refer within six months of our final response. *This is the period stated on the site and in our emails; it must be confirmed against IBAS's terms when the agreement is signed.*
- **Where we tell customers about IBAS:** on the /complaints page, in the Terms of Service, in the acknowledgement email, and in every final-response email.
- **Our commitment:** PlayStake cooperates fully with IBAS, provides the records it asks for promptly, and complies with its decisions. *Confirm the binding nature of decisions against the IBAS agreement.*
- **Changing provider:** any change of ADR provider will be notified to the Commission as a key event, and the site and emails updated first.

7. Records and reporting

- **What is kept:** each complaint, its full history, the final response and the outcome. These are kept for at least 5 years and are not deleted with the customer's account.
- **Regulatory returns:** complaint volumes, categories, outcomes, timeliness and IBAS referrals are included in the Commission's regulatory returns.
- **Board reporting:** the same figures go into the quarterly board compliance report.
- **Trend review:** the Complaints Manager reviews complaint trends each quarter and feeds lessons into product and policy changes.

8. Review

Version	Date	Change
0.1	30 September 2026	First draft

Policy 03 — Self-Exclusion

Operator	[COMPANY NAME], trading as PlayStake
Owner	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], Safer Gambling Lead
Version	0.1 — draft for licence application
Review	Annually
Relates to	LCCP social responsibility code 3.5.3 (self-exclusion, remote), and 3.5.6 (multi-operator self-exclusion — see Policy 04); marketing restrictions for self-excluded customers

> Draft for review by a compliance adviser. LCCP references to be confirmed against the current version.

1. Purpose

Self-exclusion lets a customer stop themselves gambling with PlayStake for a period they choose. The period can't be undone while it runs. This policy explains:

- how customers self-exclude
- what happens while they are excluded
- how exclusion ends
- how the platform makes sure an excluded customer cannot gamble with us or be marketed to

It also covers the shorter **cool-off** break, which works in the same way for a shorter time. Participation in the national scheme, GAMSTOP, is covered in Policy 04.

2. Periods offered

Option	Periods
Self-exclusion	6 months, 1 year, 2 years, 5 years
Cool-off (take a break)	24 hours, 72 hours, 1 week, 1 month, 6 weeks

The minimum self-exclusion is six months.

3. How customers self-exclude

- **Self-service:** from **Safer Gambling** in their account, available from every page in the account area.
  - The customer picks a period.
  - A confirmation screen explains in plain English:
    - what happens
    - that the exclusion cannot be shortened or lifted early by the customer or by our staff
    - that they can still sign in and withdraw their balance
    - that anything waiting in a lobby, and any challenges, will be withdrawn
    - that when the period ends the account stays closed to gambling until they ask to return

    - The customer must confirm before the exclusion starts.
- **By contacting us:**
    - A customer can ask by email (admin@playstake.org) or any other contact.
    - Staff apply it straight away from the customer's admin page, recording how the customer asked.
    - This is audited, and the same rules apply as for self-service.
    - Staff must never try to talk a customer out of self-excluding.
- **Confirmation:** the customer gets an email confirming the exclusion and its end date, with GamCare's details.
- **Signposting:** the Safer Gambling page tells customers about GAMSTOP, so they can exclude from every UK-licensed online operator at once, and gives the contact details for GamCare (0808 8020 133) and BeGambleAware.

4. What happens during self-exclusion

From the moment a self-exclusion starts:

1. **No gambling.** Every deposit, stake and game entry passes the eligibility check (Master Manual §5.1). A self-excluded customer is refused at each of:
    - depositing
    - joining a lobby
    - sending an invite
    - accepting an invite or challenge
    - issuing a challenge
    - starting a free-to-play game
2. **Open activity is withdrawn.** The following are cancelled at once, so they cannot be drawn into a match:
    - the customer's waiting lobby entries
    - invites they have received
    - challenges they have sent or received

    Nothing needs refunding at this point, because stakes are only taken once a match is agreed.
3. **They can't be pulled into a match by someone else.** If another player tries to accept a challenge from a customer who has since self-excluded, the platform re-checks the customer before taking their stake, and refuses. The other player is told only that the player "isn't available". The reason is never disclosed.
4. **Matches already agreed** before the exclusion run to their normal end and settle as usual. Voiding them would unfairly affect the opponent.
5. **Withdrawals stay open.** The customer can still sign in and withdraw their whole balance at any time. On request, staff close the account and return the balance.
6. **No marketing or optional emails.** While any break is in force, the customer receives only essential emails (security, payments, responsible play). They get no promotional email even if they previously consented to it (including emails when a streamer they follow goes live), no optional notifications, and no in-app go-live alerts. The same applies to customers registered with GAMSTOP and to restricted accounts.

7. **No early end.** The exclusion cannot be shortened or lifted by the customer or by staff. The platform only allows it to be replaced by a longer one.
8. **It follows the person.** If the excluded customer opens another account, the new account's identity documents are matched to them at verification. The same exclusion is applied to the new account automatically, and a case is opened for staff to review (Policy 01 §3.2).

5. How self-exclusion ends

A self-exclusion does **not** lapse on its own:

1. When the period ends, the customer is emailed. The email explains that their account **stays closed to gambling**, that nothing changes unless they choose to come back, how to return if they want to, and where to get support.
2. To return, the customer must take a **positive action**: asking to return from Safer Gambling and confirming it.
3. Access then resumes after a **24-hour cooling-off period**. During that time the account stays closed, and the page shows when it reopens. The customer is encouraged to set deposit limits first.

A cool-off ends automatically at the end of its period, and the customer is emailed when it does.

6. Staff responsibilities

The Safer Gambling Lead is responsible for:

- applying self-exclusions requested by email or phone the same day, and recording how the request arrived
- never shortening, lifting or trying to talk a customer out of a self-exclusion (the platform prevents this anyway)
- when a shared-identity case shows a new account linked to a self-excluded person, confirming the exclusion was applied, and considering whether the customer should be contacted with support information
- making sure no marketing list or promotion ever includes excluded customers (the platform enforces this for its own emails; any external or manual marketing must be filtered against the platform's exclusion data first)
- checking a sample of self-exclusions every month, to confirm they were applied correctly and no gambling or marketing followed

7. Records

- **What is kept:** self-exclusions and breaks (start, end, return request, return effective date).
- **How long:** kept even if the customer's account is later deleted, for at least 5 years after the exclusion ends.
- **Audit trail:** staff-applied exclusions appear in the admin audit log.

8. Review

Version	Date	Change
0.1	30 September 2026	First draft

Policy 04 — Multi-Operator Self-Exclusion (GAMSTOP)

Operator	[COMPANY NAME], trading as PlayStake
Owner	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], Head of Compliance
Version	0.1 — draft for licence application
Review	Annually, and on any change to GAMSTOP's integration requirements
Relates to	LCCP social responsibility code 3.5.6 — participation in the national online multi-operator self-exclusion scheme (GAMSTOP)

> Draft for review by a compliance adviser. **Status: PlayStake has not yet joined GAMSTOP.** The integration is built and tested, and switches on with configuration once membership and API credentials are in place (section 6).

1. Purpose

GAMSTOP lets a person exclude themselves from every online gambling business licensed in Great Britain in one step. Remote operators must take part in the scheme and must not let a GAMSTOP-registered person gamble. This policy describes how PlayStake checks GAMSTOP and acts on the result.

2. When PlayStake checks GAMSTOP

The check needs the customer's identity. PlayStake uses the details from their identity-verification submission: legal first and last name, date of birth, postcode and email address.

When	What happens
Identity verification submitted	Checked as soon as identity is known, before the account is approved.
Every sign-in	Checked again on each sign-in. A GAMSTOP outage here never blocks sign-in, because the customer may need to withdraw.
Before any deposit, stake or game entry	The eligibility check (Master Manual §5.1) uses the stored result if it is under 24 hours old. Otherwise it checks GAMSTOP again first.

3. How the result is used

GAMSTOP result	What PlayStake does
Registered (excluded)	The customer cannot deposit, stake or play, and is told why in plain terms. They can still sign in and **withdraw their balance**. They receive no marketing or optional emails.
Previously registered (exclusion lapsed)	Treated as not excluded for access. The fact is visible to staff on the customer's admin page, and staff may consider it in customer-interaction decisions.

GAMSTOP result	What PlayStake does
Not registered	No restriction.
Check could not be completed (timeout or error)	**Fails closed.** The deposit or stake is refused with a "try again shortly" message, and the failure is logged. If a customer has never been checked, they cannot gamble until a check succeeds.

Staff view. The latest result and the time it was checked are shown on the customer's admin page.

Launch safeguard. A production setting (`GAMSTOP_REQUIRED=true`) makes the platform refuse all gambling if the GAMSTOP integration is ever switched off or misconfigured. Gambling can never quietly continue without the check.

4. Other controls that work alongside GAMSTOP

- **Signposting.** The Safer Gambling page, and the site footer on every public page, tell customers about GAMSTOP and link to it.
- **Our own exclusion.** PlayStake's own self-exclusion (Policy 03) works independently of GAMSTOP, and applies to a person across all of their accounts.

5. Records

- **Stored on the account:** the latest GAMSTOP result and the time it was checked.
- **Logged:** failed checks.
- **Not stored:** the details sent to GAMSTOP are not kept in addition to the identity-verification record.

6. Go-live steps (outstanding)

1. Apply to join GAMSTOP and sign the operator agreement.
2. Obtain API credentials. Confirm the current API endpoint, the required fields, and how the response is returned. The integration expects GAMSTOP's operator API (form fields: first name, last name, date of birth, email, postcode, mobile; an `X-Exclusion` response header of Y, N or P). *Confirm against GAMSTOP's current specification.*
3. Decide whether to collect a **mobile number** at identity verification, since GAMSTOP accepts it and it may improve matching.
4. Set `GAMSTOP_API_KEY` and `GAMSTOP_REQUIRED=true` in production (and `GAMSTOP_API_URL` if GAMSTOP specifies a different endpoint).
5. Run GAMSTOP's test cases against the staging environment and keep the evidence.
6. Record the go-live date in this policy's version history.

7. Review

Version	Date	Change
0.1	30 September 2026	First draft; integration built, awaiting membership

Policy 05 — Customer Interaction and Harm Prevention

Operator	[COMPANY NAME], trading as PlayStake
Owner	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], Safer Gambling Lead
Version	0.1 — draft for licence application
Review	Annually; the effectiveness data (section 6) is reviewed every quarter
Relates to	LCCP social responsibility code 3.4.3 (customer interaction, remote) and the Commission's customer interaction guidance ("identify, act, evaluate"); financial vulnerability / affordability requirements; restrictions on marketing to customers at risk; the requirement to offer financial limits

> Draft for review by a compliance adviser. **The Commission's current thresholds for financial vulnerability checks and its rules on prompting customers to set limits must be confirmed, and PlayStake's thresholds set to match** (see section 3.2 and Master Manual §8 item 16).

1. Purpose

PlayStake must spot customers who may be experiencing, or be at risk of, gambling harm, act quickly and appropriately, and check whether what it did worked. This policy describes the system that does that.

Scale does not excuse us. Player-versus-player wagering on competitive games can be fast, emotional and repeated: a loss invites a rematch. PlayStake treats harm prevention as a core function, not an add-on.

2. Tools every customer has

These tools are available to every customer, from **Safer Gambling** in their account:

- **Deposit limits:**
  - daily, weekly and monthly, over rolling periods
  - lowering a limit takes effect immediately
  - raising or removing a limit only takes effect after 24 hours, so it can't be done in the heat of a session
- **A limit prompt before the first deposit.** Before their first deposit, every customer must either set a deposit limit or actively decline to. The platform enforces this, not just the page, and records the answer.
- **Cool-off breaks and self-exclusion.** See Policy 03.
- **Reality checks:**
  - optional reminders every 15, 30, 60 or 120 minutes
  - each one shows how long the customer has been playing, how many bets they have placed, how much they have staked, and their net result
  - each one offers to take them to Safer Gambling
  - they run on the dashboard and on the game pages
- **Support information** from GamCare and BeGambleAware, and GAMSTOP signposting.

3. Identify: markers of harm

A scan runs **every 15 minutes**. It covers every customer who has played or deposited in the last 24 hours and looks for these markers:

Marker	Triggered when	Severity
Loss chasing — stakes	Three or more consecutive losses in 24 hours, with the last stake at least double the first	Low at 2×, medium at 3×, high at 4×
Loss chasing — deposits	Three or more deposits in 24 hours, each within 30 minutes of a losing result	Medium; high at six or more
Rapid deposits	Five deposits in an hour, or ten in 24 hours	Medium; high at double those numbers
High deposit volume (affordability)	Completed deposits over 30 days at or above the affordability threshold (setting `AFFORDABILITY_REVIEW_THRESHOLD_CENTS`; currently 2,000.00)	Medium; high at double
Late-night play	Five or more bets settled between midnight and 6am UK time in 24 hours	Low; medium at ten or more

Signal frequency. Each marker raises a signal at most once in 24 hours per customer, or once in 30 days for high deposit volume, so a single episode doesn't flood the queue.

Other indicators staff consider during review. Some indicators are not yet automated. Staff consider them whenever they review a customer. They are:

- how the customer uses the gambling management tools, such as raising or removing limits or ending breaks
- repeated declined deposits or cancelled withdrawals
- time spent on the site
- a complaint or other contact that suggests distress
- anything else the customer tells us

Customer-led contact. Any contact from a customer that suggests harm, whether a complaint, an email or something else, must be recorded by staff as an interaction on that customer (see section 4.2).

3.1 Customers we already know about

Some customers are already handled before any scan runs. If a customer has self-excluded, is on a break, is registered with GAMSTOP, or has a restricted account, they cannot gamble at all.

3.2 Affordability and financial vulnerability

Current threshold. The high-deposit-volume marker is PlayStake's affordability trigger. It is set at 2,000.00 of deposits over 30 days.

Aligning with the Commission. Before launch, this threshold must be set at or below the level at which the Commission requires financial vulnerability checks. Our AML enhanced due diligence threshold (Policy 07, 5,000.00 over 30 days) requires source-of-funds evidence. Customers who cannot show that their spending is

affordable are restricted.

Planned improvement. Adding a credit-reference-based financial vulnerability check is a planned improvement once a provider is appointed.

4. Act

4.1 Immediately, and automatically

When a marker is raised, three things happen straight away:

1. **The customer is contacted.** The next time they are on the site (dashboard or games), they see a supportive message suited to the marker. For example, for loss chasing: "*We noticed your stakes have been going up after a run of losses. Chasing losses is one of the most common ways gambling stops being fun…*". Every message includes GamCare's free 24/7 number.
   - The message stays until the customer responds. They can:
     - set a deposit limit (taken straight to Safer Gambling)
     - take a break
     - say they're OK
   - Their response is recorded.
2. **Marketing stops.** For 30 days after a marker, the customer receives no marketing or optional emails, unless staff review and dismiss the signal.
3. **Staff are alerted.** The Safer Gambling Lead receives an email alert linking to the signal.

4.2 Staff review

Every signal appears in the **Harm signals** queue (`/admin/harm-signals`). For each signal, staff see:

- what was observed and over what period
- the customer's deposits and stakes over the last 30 days
- the customer's other signals
- every past interaction with the customer

Staff decide what is proportionate, from light-touch to strong:

Step	When	How it's recorded
Record a note	The automated message is enough; watch for recurrence	Interaction (note)
Email or phone the customer	Medium or high severity, repeated signals, or no response to the automated message	Interaction (email / phone call), with a follow-up date
Apply a deposit limit	Spending looks unaffordable, or the customer agrees to one	Interaction (deposit limit applied). The platform only allows staff to *lower* a limit, never raise it.
Apply a cool-off	Signs of acute harm, or the customer asks	Interaction (cool-off applied)
Suspend the account	Serious concern, or no engagement after repeated interactions	Account status change with a reason (audited)
Close the account	Customer request, or strong evidence of harm	Account status change with a reason (audited)

Closing the review. Staff close the signal as **reviewed** or **dismissed**, with notes explaining what they found and decided. This is recorded in the admin audit log.

Target times:

- high-severity signals: reviewed within 24 hours
- all others: within 5 working days

Staff conduct. Staff never encourage further gambling, and never offer bonuses or incentives to a customer with an open signal. PlayStake does not currently run bonuses at all.

5. Evaluate

Automatic evaluation. Fourteen days after each interaction, the platform compares the customer's deposits and stakes in the 14 days before the interaction with the 14 days after, and records the outcome:

Outcome	Meaning
Customer took a break	A cool-off or self-exclusion was started after the interaction
Customer set a limit	A deposit limit was set or changed after the interaction
Behaviour improved	Deposits plus stakes fell to 75% or less of the previous 14 days
Behaviour unchanged	No meaningful change. **Staff are alerted to consider a stronger step.**

Manual outcomes. Staff can also record outcomes themselves, such as "escalated" or "no response".

6. Measuring effectiveness

The Harm signals page includes an effectiveness table. For each marker and each type of interaction, it shows how many interactions led to each outcome. Every quarter, the Safer Gambling Lead:

1. reviews the table, alongside complaint and self-exclusion trends
2. decides whether each automated message, threshold and staff response is working
3. adjusts thresholds, messages or escalation rules where it is not
4. records the conclusions and any changes in the quarterly board compliance report and in this policy's version history

7. Training

Everyone who works with customers or the admin tools is trained before starting, and every year after. The training covers:

- recognising the signs of gambling harm
- how to have a supportive conversation
- what the platform does automatically
- how to record interactions
- when to escalate

8. Records

These records are kept even if the customer's account is later deleted, for at least 5 years:

- signals
- interactions
- responses
- outcomes
- review notes

9. Review

Version	Date	Change
0.1	30 September 2026	First draft

Policy 06 — Age Verification

Operator	[COMPANY NAME], trading as PlayStake
Owner	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], Head of Compliance
Version	0.1 — draft for licence application
Review	Annually, and when an electronic verification provider is appointed
Relates to	Licensing objective 3 (protecting children); Gambling Act 2005 ss.46–47 (inviting or permitting a child or young person to gamble); LCCP social responsibility code 3.2.11 (remote age verification: verify age before a customer can deposit, access free-to-play games, or gamble); LCCP customer identity verification requirements

> Draft for review by a compliance adviser. LCCP references to be confirmed against the current version.

1. Purpose

Nobody under 18 may gamble with PlayStake. Remote operators must verify a customer's age **before** they can deposit, access free-to-play games, or gamble. This policy explains how PlayStake does that and what happens if an under-18 gets through.

2. Principles

- **Verify first.** Age is verified before any deposit, any free-to-play game, and any gambling. No product lets anyone play first and verify later.
- **Fail closed.** Anything short of full verification blocks all gambling.
- **No shortcuts.** Staff cannot mark a customer as age-verified without an approved identity document showing they are 18 or over. The platform enforces this.

3. How age is verified

3.1 At sign-up

- **Email sign-up.** Customers who sign up with email must give their date of birth and actively tick a box confirming they are 18 or over. The box also confirms that their age and identity will be checked before they can deposit or play. Anyone whose date of birth makes them under 18 is refused, and no account is created. The date of birth and the time of the confirmation are recorded.
- **Google sign-in.** Customers who sign in with Google do not give a date of birth at sign-up. They go through exactly the same identity verification (section 3.2) before they can deposit or play.
- **Marketing.** Marketing consent is a separate, unticked, optional box.

Sign-up does not verify age. It only stops an under-18 who admits their age from opening an account. Verification happens in section 3.2.

3.2 Identity and age verification (KYC)

Before any deposit, free-to-play access or gambling, the customer must complete identity verification. The steps are:

1. **Email address verified first.**
2. **Details and documents submitted.** The customer enters their legal name, date of birth and address, and uploads:
   - a passport (photo page), a driving licence (front and back) or a national ID card (front and back)
   - a selfie
3. **Automatic checks when submitted:**
   - the date of birth entered must show the customer is 18 or over
   - files must be genuine images or PDFs (checked from the file contents, not the file name) and no larger than 8 MB
   - documents are encrypted as soon as they are received (AES-256-GCM)
4. **Identity screening:**
   - the document date of birth is compared with the one given at sign-up; a mismatch opens a case and blocks approval
   - the same name and date of birth, or the same document image, on another account opens a case and blocks approval (one person, one account)
   - GAMSTOP is checked (Policy 04)
5. **Manual review by trained staff**, at `/admin/kyc`. The reviewer checks that:
   - the document is genuine and unaltered, and not expired
   - the name and date of birth on the document match what the customer entered
   - the selfie matches the document photo
   - the address is plausible and consistent
6. **Age re-checked at approval.** When the reviewer approves, the platform re-checks age from the document's date of birth. It refuses approval if the customer is under 18, and tells the reviewer to close the account as under-18 instead.
7. **Decision.** Every approval and rejection is recorded, with the reviewer and their notes, in the admin audit log. A rejection must include a reason, which the customer is told.

Outstanding (Master Manual §8 item 4). An electronic identity and age verification provider will be added to supplement manual review. It will provide document-authenticity checks, liveness detection and a credit-reference or electoral-roll age check. Until then, every submission is reviewed manually and nothing is approved automatically.

3.3 Where verification is enforced

The eligibility check (Master Manual §5.1) requires verified identity for every one of these actions:

Action	Blocked until verified?
Depositing	Yes
Entering the games (`/play`), including free-to-play games	Yes
Joining a lobby, sending or accepting an invite, issuing or accepting a challenge	Yes

Action	Blocked until verified?
Having a stake locked when an opponent accepts a match	Yes (the opponent is re-checked)
Withdrawing	Yes
Applying to be a referee	Verified identity is required before approval and before officiating

Explaining the block. A notice on the games page tells an unverified customer they can't play yet and links to verification.

No manual override. Staff cannot set a customer to "verified" by hand unless an approved identity document shows they are 18 or over. The attempt is refused.

4. If an under-18 is found

An under-18 may be found in several ways: at verification, through a document review, a report from a parent, or information from a payment provider. Whenever it happens, staff act at once:

1. **Close the account as under-18** from the customer's admin page, giving a reason. The platform then automatically:
   - **voids every unsettled bet** they are party to, returning both players' stakes, because an under-18 cannot lawfully win or lose a bet
   - withdraws their lobby entries, invites and challenges
   - signs them out everywhere and prevents them signing in again
   - records the action, including their balance at the time and the voided bets, in the admin audit log
2. **Return their money.** The Head of Compliance arranges for the account's deposits to be returned to their source, outside the platform. Winnings are not paid.
3. **Review settled bets.** For bets that settled before the account was closed, the Head of Compliance reviews each one:
   - stakes the customer lost are returned as part of step 2
   - opponents who lost money to the under-18 are refunded by PlayStake where appropriate
   - every decision is recorded on the customer's record
4. **Consider reporting.** Decide whether to report to the Gambling Commission (for example, as a key event if a control failed) and whether safeguarding concerns need to be raised.
5. **Learn.** Establish how the customer got through verification, and fix the cause.

An under-18 closure **cannot be reversed**. Someone who has since turned 18 must open a new account and be fully verified.

5. Marketing and product design

- PlayStake's marketing is aimed only at adults. It does not use content, games, influencers or channels with particular appeal to under-18s.
- The site footer and every email footer state "18+ only", and the Terms of Service set 18 as the minimum age. Email footers also carry GamCare's free support number.
- Streamer partners on Kick must be over 18 and verified. Their PlayStake content must not target under-18s.

6. Monitoring and testing

The Head of Compliance carries out checks every quarter:

- **Sample check.** Re-check a sample of approved identity verifications against their documents.
- **Test the controls.** Confirm that an unverified test account cannot deposit, enter the games or stake. The automated test suite also checks this on every code change.

The results are included in the quarterly board compliance report.

7. Records

- **Identity documents:** kept encrypted for the retention period in the Privacy Policy. They are only ever decrypted when a reviewer deliberately opens them.
- **Verification decisions:** kept even if the account is deleted, and recorded in the audit log.
- **Under-18 closures:** permanent on the account.

8. Review

Version	Date	Change
0.1	30 September 2026	First draft

Policy 07 — Anti-Money Laundering and Counter-Terrorist Financing: Risk Assessment and Controls

Operator	[COMPANY NAME], trading as PlayStake
Owner	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], Money Laundering Reporting Officer (MLRO)
Version	0.1 — draft for licence application
Review	**At least annually**, and before launching any new product, game type, payment method or technology, or when a significant new risk or typology is identified (section 9)
Relates to	LCCP licence condition 12.1.1 (anti-money laundering: assess ML/TF risks and have appropriate policies, procedures and controls, reviewed as necessary and at least annually); Proceeds of Crime Act 2002 (POCA) Part 7; Terrorism Act 2000; sanctions regimes administered by OFSI; the Commission's guidance "*The prevention of money laundering and combating the financing of terrorism — guidance for remote and non-remote operators (excluding casinos)*"

> Draft for review by a compliance adviser. **Regulatory position:** as a non-casino operator, PlayStake is expected not to be a "relevant person" under the Money Laundering, Terrorist Financing and Transfer of Funds Regulations 2017 (which apply to casino licensees). It is, however, fully subject to POCA, the Terrorism Act and the LCCP. PlayStake nevertheless applies customer due diligence, monitoring and record-keeping to a standard informed by the Regulations. *Confirm this position with legal advisers for the licence type applied for.*
>
> All monetary thresholds below are defaults in the platform, currently in US dollars because payments are in Stripe test mode. They must be converted to pounds sterling and confirmed in this assessment before launch (Master Manual §8 items 6 and 9).

Part A — Risk assessment

A1. Method

The assessment works as follows:

1. **Identify risks.** Money laundering and terrorist financing risks are identified across six factors: customers, products and games, transactions, delivery channels, payment methods and geography.
2. **Rate inherent risk.** Each risk is rated for likelihood (Low, Medium or High) and impact (Low, Medium or High), before controls, giving an inherent risk.
3. **Rate residual risk.** Each risk is then rated again after PlayStake's controls, giving a residual risk.

Current assessment. It is based on the platform as built on 30 September 2026, before real-money launch. There is no live transaction history yet. The first review after launch must use real data (section 9).

A2. The business model and why it matters

PlayStake customers stake money against **each other** on games they play themselves. PlayStake holds both stakes in escrow and pays the winner, less a platform fee. It never takes a position.

This creates a risk that doesn't exist, or is much smaller, in house-banked betting: **value transfer between customers**. If two accounts are controlled by the same person, or by people acting together, one can deliberately lose to the other. That moves money from one account to another with a gambling transaction as cover. This is "chip dumping" (or "soft play"). The receiving account then withdraws the "winnings". It is the dominant money laundering typology for this business, and most of the controls in Part B are built around it.

A3. Risk register

#	Risk	Factor	Inherent (L × I)	Key controls (Part B)	Residual
1	**Chip dumping.** Colluding accounts pass value by losing on purpose.	Product / transactions	High × High = **High**	One-person-one-account screening (B2.3); chip-dumping detection (B3.1); head-to-head cap of 5 matches an hour (B3.2); shared-IP detection (B3.1); withdrawal holds (B4)	**Medium**
2	**Deposit-and-withdraw without play.** Criminal funds are deposited, lightly played or not played, and withdrawn as apparently legitimate funds.	Transactions	Medium × High = **High**	Deposit-and-withdraw-without-play detection and a real-time withdrawal hold (B3.1, B4); payouts only to a verified bank account (B4)	**Low–Medium**
3	**Spending the proceeds of crime.** A customer gambles with criminal property, a "lifestyle" risk.	Customers / transactions	Medium × High = **High**	Customer due diligence (CDD) before any deposit (B2); EDD and source of funds over the 30-day threshold (B2.4); affordability markers (Policy 05); per-transaction deposit cap	**Medium**
4	**Stolen payment methods.** Deposits are made with stolen or compromised cards.	Payment methods	Medium × Medium = **Medium**	Stripe card processing, with 3-D Secure as Stripe applies it by default; chargeback suspension and case (B3.3); *explicit 3-D Secure rules and Stripe Radar rules outstanding*	**Medium** (Low once Radar is live)
5	**Mule and multiple accounts.** Accounts are opened in other people's names, or one person runs several.	Customers	Medium × High = **High**	Document KYC with selfie and manual review; shared-identity and document-image matching; DOB cross-check; shared-IP detection; *electronic ID with liveness outstanding*	**Medium**
6	**Result manipulation to move value.** A referee or a player fixes a result.	Product	Medium × High = **High**	Independent referees who are verified, approved per game and never officiate their own matches; hash-chained referee audit; dispute window; overturn tracking; anomaly detection	**Low–Medium**

#	Risk	Factor	Inherent (L × I)	Key controls (Part B)	Residual
7	**Sanctioned persons and PEPs.**	Customers	Low × High = **Medium**	*Screening provider outstanding.* Interim: manual check against the OFSI consolidated list at KYC approval (B2.5).	**Medium**, falling to Low once automated
8	**Terrorist financing.** Small value transfers, including through the P2P mechanism.	Transactions	Low × High = **Medium**	The same controls as risks 1, 2 and 7; the MLRO reports under the Terrorism Act	**Low**
9	**Geography.** Customers or funds from high-risk or non-GB jurisdictions.	Geography	Medium × Medium = **Medium**	Country captured at KYC and reviewed at approval; *outstanding for launch: a GB-only restriction, a geolocation check, and automatic refusal of FATF high-risk jurisdictions*	**Low–Medium**
10	**Insider facilitation.** Staff approve identities improperly, lift restrictions or ignore alerts.	Delivery	Low × High = **Medium**	Staff 2FA; append-only admin audit log; platform-enforced limits on staff actions; quarterly independent review of cases	**Low**
11	**Streamer and audience channel.** Viewers on Kick challenge streamers; a streamer's audience could be used to channel funds.	Delivery channel	Medium × Medium = **Medium**	All the same controls apply to streamer challenges (it is the same lobby and escrow); referee oversight; head-to-head cap; chip-dumping detection	**Low–Medium**

Overall residual risk: Medium. This is driven by risks 1, 3 and 5. It is expected to fall once the outstanding provider-based controls (electronic ID, sanctions/PEP screening, Stripe Radar) are live, and after the first review based on live data.

Part B — Policies, procedures and controls

B1. Roles

- **The MLRO**, [COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME]:
  - owns this assessment
  - decides AML cases
  - makes Suspicious Activity Reports (SARs) and Defence Against Money Laundering (DAML) requests to the NCA
  - trains staff
  - reports to the board every quarter
- **All staff** must report any knowledge or suspicion of money laundering to the MLRO promptly. They can do this by adding a note to a case in the AML queue, or by telling the MLRO directly. Failing to report is an offence under POCA s.330.

B2. Customer due diligence

B2.1 Before any deposit

Identity is verified before any deposit, any play and any withdrawal (Policy 06):

- legal name, date of birth and address
- a photo identity document and a selfie
- manual review by trained staff

B2.2 Ongoing monitoring

- The monitoring in B3 runs on every account.
- Customers' circumstances are reviewed whenever a case is raised.

B2.3 One person, one account

At KYC, the new submission is matched against every other account:

- **Same legal name and date of birth, or the same document image** → a `SHARED_IDENTITY` case, and approval is blocked.
- **Document date of birth differs from the one given at sign-up** → a `DOB_MISMATCH` case, and approval is blocked.

B2.4 Enhanced due diligence (EDD) and source of funds

- **Trigger:** completed deposits over any 30 days at or above **5,000.00** (setting `AML_EDD_THRESHOLD_CENTS`). This opens a `HIGH_DEPOSIT_VOLUME` case.
- **What the MLRO obtains:** evidence of source of funds, such as payslips, bank statements or other documents appropriate to the amount, and, where needed, source of wealth.
- **What happens meanwhile:**
  - while the case is open, withdrawals are held (B4)
  - the MLRO may suspend the account if evidence is not provided within [14] days
- **Other EDD triggers:** EDD also applies when a customer:
  - is a PEP or connected to one (once screening is live)
  - is linked to a high-risk jurisdiction
  - is the subject of any high-severity case

B2.5 Sanctions and PEPs

Outstanding. A screening provider is to be appointed.

Interim control. Until then, at KYC approval the reviewer checks the customer's name and date of birth against the OFSI consolidated list, and notes the check in the review notes.

If a customer is a sanctions match:

1. do not approve the account
2. freeze their funds
3. report to OFSI
4. inform the MLRO

B3. Transaction monitoring

A scan runs **every 15 minutes**. Its results are cases in the **AML queue** (`/admin/aml`), and each new case alerts the MLRO by email.

B3.1 Automated detectors

Detector	Case type	Triggered when	Severity
Chip dumping	`CHIP_DUMPING` (receiver, with the sender linked)	The same two players played **5 or more** times in 7 days, one side won **80% or more** of decided games, and received at least **100.00** net (`AML_CHIP_DUMP_VALUE_CENTS`)	Medium; high at 10+ games or 5× the value
Shared IP, played each other	`SHARED_IP` (both linked)	Two accounts used the same IP address in the last 30 days **and** wagered against each other	High
Many accounts on one IP	`SHARED_IP`	Four or more accounts on one IP address in 30 days	Low (for review; households and public networks are common)
Deposit and withdraw without play	`DEPOSIT_WITHDRAW_NO_PLAY`	Deposits of at least **50.00** in 7 days (`AML_NO_PLAY_MIN_DEPOSIT_CENTS`), at least half withdrawn within 24 hours, and less than a quarter of the deposits staked	Medium
Deposits over the EDD threshold	`HIGH_DEPOSIT_VOLUME`	See B2.4	Medium; high at 2×
Identity	`SHARED_IDENTITY`, `DOB_MISMATCH`	See B2.3	High / Medium
Chargeback	`CHARGEBACK`	A card issuer dispute on a deposit	High

Signal frequency. Only one open case exists per customer, type and counterparty, so a continuing pattern doesn't flood the queue.

B3.2 Preventive controls

- **Head-to-head cap.** The same two customers can play each other at most **5 times in any hour**. Further matches are refused.
- **No self-play.** The database refuses a bet between an account and itself.
- **Deposit caps.** Each deposit must be between 5.00 and 1,000.00.

B3.3 Chargebacks

A card dispute on a deposit has two immediate effects:

- the account is **suspended**, so no stakes or withdrawals can be made
- a high-severity case is opened for the MLRO

B4. Withdrawal controls

Withdrawals are where laundered funds leave. A withdrawal request is **held for review**, and not paid, when any of these apply:

Condition	What happens
The account is suspended or closed	The withdrawal is refused
A **medium- or high-severity** AML case is open on the account	The withdrawal is held. Low-severity cases, such as a shared household IP, do not hold money.
The amount is at or above **2,000.00** (`AML_WITHDRAWAL_REVIEW_THRESHOLD_CENTS`)	A review case is opened and the withdrawal is held
The withdrawal follows deposits with little play (the B3.1 rule, counting the requested amount)	A `DEPOSIT_WITHDRAW_NO_PLAY` case is opened and the withdrawal is held

Customer message. The customer is told only that the withdrawal "needs a quick review" and that their balance is safe. They are never told about a suspicion.

Clearing a hold. When the MLRO closes the case with **no suspicion**, withdrawals of the same kind go through for the following 7 days.

Where payouts go. Payouts go only to the customer's own bank account, verified through the payment provider (Stripe Connect), after identity and email verification. *Outstanding: automatically matching the payout account holder's name to the verified legal name. Until then, the MLRO checks this manually for any held withdrawal.*

Exclusion never traps funds. Self-exclusion and GAMSTOP registration never block a withdrawal (Policies 03 and 04). Only AML and fraud controls do.

B5. Case handling and suspicious activity reporting

Every AML case is worked in the AML queue:

1. **Assign.** The investigator or MLRO takes the case.
2. **Investigate.** Review the customer's identity, transactions, betting pattern, counterparties and linked cases. Record notes on the case.
3. **Decide.** The MLRO records the reasoning for every decision on the case. The platform requires it. The decision is one of:
   - **close, no suspicion:** releases held withdrawals of that kind for 7 days
   - **close, action taken:** for example, the account was suspended or closed, or winnings were withheld under the Terms
   - **escalate to the MLRO:** where an investigator has worked the case
   - **SAR submitted:** the MLRO records the NCA reference on the case
4. **Report.** Where the MLRO knows or suspects money laundering or terrorist financing, or has reasonable grounds to, they make a SAR to the NCA through the SAR Online portal as soon as practicable. Where PlayStake would otherwise pay out or process funds it suspects are criminal property, the MLRO requests a **DAML** first, and the funds stay held (the withdrawal hold) until consent is given or the statutory period ends. Every SAR decision is recorded, including decisions *not* to report and why.

5. **Don't tip off.** Nobody may tell the customer, or anyone else, that a SAR has been considered or made, or that an investigation is under way (POCA s.333A). The customer-facing messages are written with this in mind. The AML case page reminds staff.
6. **Notify the Commission** where the LCCP requires it. SARs themselves are not shared with the Commission except as the law allows.

Every action on a case is recorded in the append-only admin audit log.

B6. Record keeping

The following are kept for **at least 5 years** after the business relationship ends, or after the transaction for occasional transactions:

- CDD records and documents
- transaction and ledger records (the double-entry ledger is immutable by design)
- AML cases and their notes and decisions
- SAR decisions and references

These records are protected from deletion with the customer's account. SAR-related records are held so that they can be produced to the NCA or the courts when required.

B7. Training

All staff receive AML training before starting and every year after. It covers:

- the offences (POCA ss.327–330 and s.333A; the Terrorism Act)
- PlayStake's typologies, especially chip dumping
- red flags
- how to report to the MLRO
- tipping off

The MLRO keeps training records and tests understanding.

B8. Governance

The MLRO reports every quarter to the board on:

- case volumes by type
- time to decision
- SARs and DAMLs (numbers only)
- withdrawal holds
- any control weaknesses

The quarterly independent review (Master Manual §3) samples closed cases.

Part C — Review triggers

This assessment is reviewed **at least annually**, and before or immediately after any of these:

- a new product, game type or match type (for example, a new third-party game category)

- a new payment method, currency or payout route, including the move from test mode to live payments in GBP
- new technology, such as a new identity or verification provider, or a change to how results are determined
- entering a new market or jurisdiction
- a significant change in volumes or customer behaviour, or a new typology seen in cases or in Commission or NCA publications
- a material control failure, or findings from the independent review

The first live-data review must be carried out **3 months after real-money launch**. It will re-rate each risk using real transaction data and recalibrate the thresholds in B2.4, B3.1 and B4.

Version history

Version	Date	Change
0.1	30 September 2026	First draft, pre-launch assessment

Document 08 — System Diagram and Outsourcing Map

Operator	[COMPANY NAME], trading as PlayStake
Owner	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], Head of Compliance (with engineering)
Version	0.1 — draft for licence application
Review	On any new supplier, hosting change or new product; at least annually
Relates to	Remote operating licence application: system diagram with commentary; LCCP 15.2.1 key events (outsourcing of key functions); RTS security requirements (Document 13)

> Draft prepared from the platform as built on 30 September 2026. Items in `[BRACKETS]` must be completed before submission. Where a supplier is "planned", no contract exists yet and the function is not live.

1. Purpose

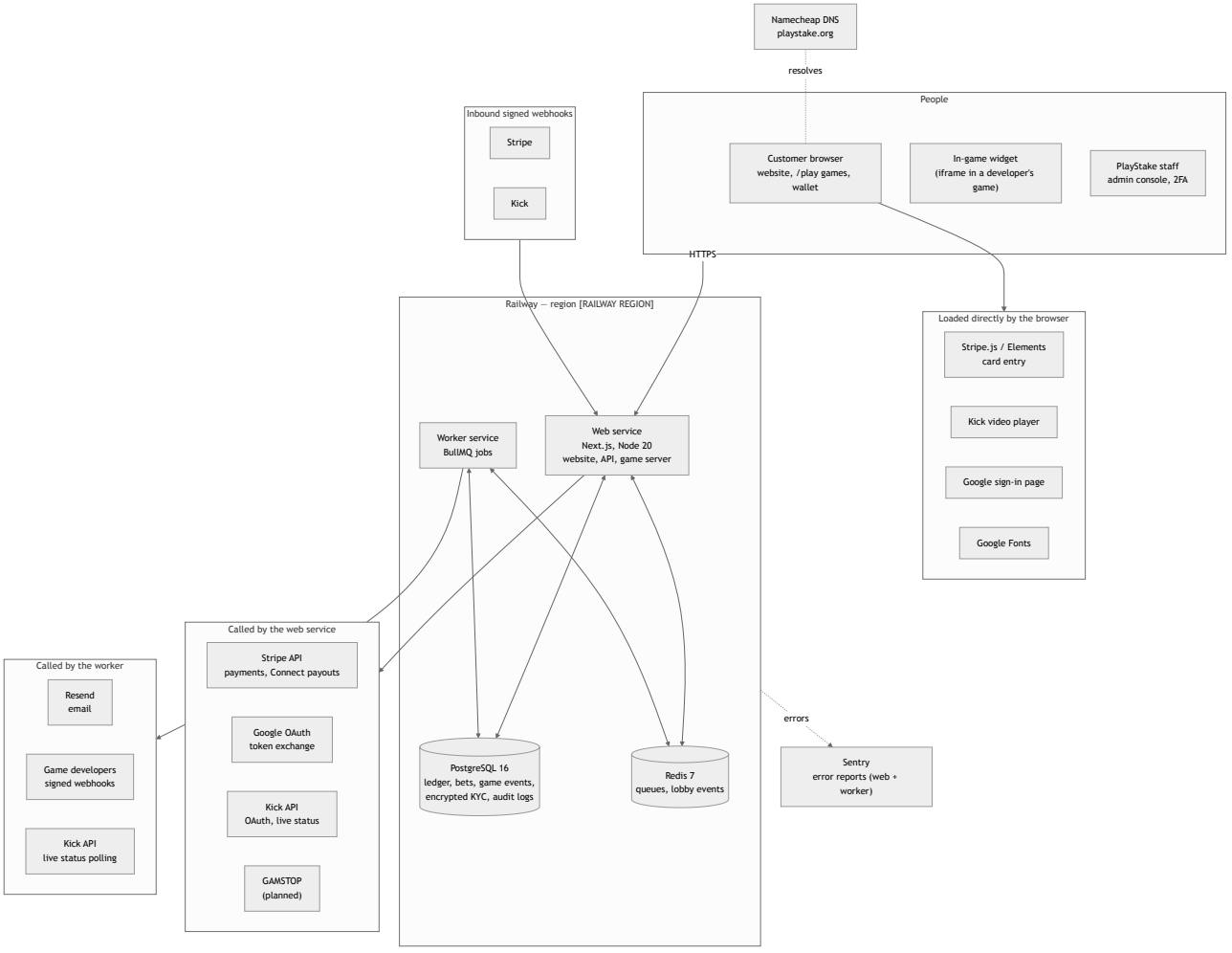
This document gives the Commission a single picture of the PlayStake gambling system: every component, who provides and operates it, where it runs, and how data and money flow between components. It also lists every function we rely on a third party for (the outsourcing map). Document 09 follows a customer through the system end to end. Document 10 maps each activity to its location, provider and operator.

2. Summary

PlayStake is a single web application with a separate background-worker process, a PostgreSQL database and a Redis instance. All four are hosted by one provider (Railway). PlayStake writes and operates all of its gambling software itself: game logic, random number generation, the wallet and ledger, result handling, and all compliance controls. No third-party gambling software, game content or platform is used.

Third parties provide: card payments and payouts (Stripe), transactional email (Resend), error monitoring (Sentry), optional sign-in (Google), live-stream integration (Kick), domain name registration and DNS (Namecheap), source control and build checks (GitHub). The national self-exclusion check (GAMSTOP) and dispute resolution (IBAS) are contracted but not yet live.

3. System diagram



3.1 Commentary

- **One application, two processes.** The web service answers every request from customers, staff and game developers. The worker service runs everything time-based: settlement after the dispute window, expiry of unanswered bets, no-show voiding, dispute escalation, anomaly and harm detection, AML scans, the daily ledger audit, email delivery, outbound webhooks, deposit-limit activation and session cleanup. Both processes are deployed from the same code and connect to the same database.
- **The database is the system of record.** Balances exist only as ledger accounts in PostgreSQL, changed only through a double-entry `transfer()` that writes two balancing entries. Ledger entries, game events, the admin audit log and referee audit events cannot be edited or deleted (database triggers reject it).
- **Games run on our servers.** For every `/play` game, the server holds the rules and state, draws every random outcome (Node.js `crypto.randomInt`, a CSPRNG) and decides the result. The browser only sends what the player did. See Document 11 for testing.
- **Card data never reaches PlayStake.** Card entry uses Stripe Elements, loaded from Stripe, so PlayStake never sees or stores card numbers. Stripe tells us about payments through signed webhooks, which are verified before any balance changes.
- **Redis holds no money and no customer records.** It carries job queues, real-time lobby events and the worker heartbeat. Losing it delays background work; it does not lose funds or records.
- **Identity documents** are stored in PostgreSQL encrypted with AES-256-GCM, under a key held only in the hosting environment. Every staff view is logged.

4. Outsourcing map

"Operated by" is who runs the service day to day. "Data shared" is what leaves PlayStake. Every supplier is a key supplier in the sense of LCCP 15.2.1 unless marked otherwise; changes are notified as key events (Document 14).

Function	Supplier	Status	What they do	Data shared	Where processed	Contract / assurance
Hosting and storage	Railway Corp.	Live	Runs the web and worker services, PostgreSQL and Redis; database backups (to be confirmed as enabled, Document 13)	All platform data (hosted, not accessed by Railway for its own purposes)	[RAILWAY REGION]. Confirm and record.	Railway terms and DPA. [CONFIRM SOC 2 REPORT]
Payment services	Stripe Payments Europe / Stripe, Inc.	Live, **test mode**	Card deposits (Payment Intents), withdrawals via Stripe Connect Express, Radar fraud screening (to configure)	Customer name, email, amount; card data handled by Stripe only	Stripe (EU/US)	Stripe Services Agreement; PCI DSS Level 1; PSR authorisation and approved methods in Policy 16
Age and identity verification	In-house	Live	Customers upload an identity document; staff review it before any deposit or gambling	—	PlayStake (Railway)	—
	[eIDV PROVIDER]	Planned	Electronic identity, age, liveness and document checks	Name, date of birth, address, document images	[TBC]	To contract (Master Manual §8 item 4)
Sanctions and PEP screening	[SCREENING PROVIDER]	Planned	Screening at verification and on list updates	Name, date of birth, nationality	[TBC]	To contract (Master Manual §8 item 5)
Multi-operator self-exclusion	GAMSTOP (The National Online Self Exclusion Scheme Ltd)	Planned	Checks every customer against the national register	Name, date of birth, email, postcode	UK	Membership to complete (Master Manual §8 item 3)
Geolocation	None	**Gap**	No IP-based location check today. Customers state their country at verification.	—	—	See §6

Function	Supplier	Status	What they do	Data shared	Where processed	Contract / assurance
Fraud detection	In-house	Live	Anomaly detection (win rates, winner patterns, fast settlement, volume spikes), shared-identity checks, AML scans	—	PlayStake	—
	Stripe Radar	To configure	Card-fraud scoring on deposits	As payment services	Stripe	As payment services
Customer service	In-house	Live	admin@playstake.org, complaints procedure, in-app messages	—	PlayStake staff	—
Alternative dispute resolution	IBAS	To sign	Independent adjudication of unresolved complaints	Complaint file, on referral only	UK	ADR agreement (Master Manual §8 item 2)
Marketing	None	—	No marketing providers, affiliates or ad networks. No analytics or tracking scripts.	—	—	—
Transactional email	Resend	Live	Sends account, bet, safer-gambling and complaint emails from an outbox	Email address, name, message content	[RESEND REGION]	Resend terms and DPA
Error monitoring	Functional Software (Sentry)	Optional, live when `SENTRY_DSN` set	Receives error reports; session replay disabled	Error context (may include user ID)	[SENTRY REGION]	Sentry terms and DPA
Sign-in	Google (OAuth)	Live, optional	Lets customers sign in with a Google account	Email, name (from Google)	Google	Google API terms
Live streaming	Kick	Live	Channel linking (OAuth), live status, webhooks, embedded video player for stream matches	Kick channel ID and tokens (tokens encrypted at rest)	Kick	Kick developer terms
Domain and DNS	Namecheap	Live	Registers playstake.org and serves its DNS	None	Namecheap	Namecheap terms

Function	Supplier	Status	What they do	Data shared	Where processed	Contract / assurance
Source control and build checks	GitHub (Microsoft)	Live	Hosts source code; runs tests, dependency audit and malware scan on each change	Source code only; no customer data	GitHub	GitHub terms
Web fonts	Google Fonts	Live	Serves font files to browsers	Visitor IP address (to Google)	Google	Google terms. Consider self-hosting (§6).
Game developers (widget integrations)	Each developer	Live	Receive signed bet-lifecycle webhooks for their own games	Bet IDs, amounts, outcomes for their game	Developer's systems	Developer terms

5. What is not outsourced

- All gambling software: game logic and random number generation, the wallet and double-entry ledger, escrow, settlement, result verification, disputes and referees.
- Every compliance control: eligibility gate, deposit limits, breaks and self-exclusion, reality checks, customer interaction, AML scans, complaints handling, audit logging.
- Customer data processing: it runs only in PlayStake's own services on Railway.

6. Gaps and actions

#	Gap	Action	Needed for
1	Hosting region not recorded	Confirm the Railway region for each service and the backup location; record here and in Document 10	Application
2	No geolocation control	Decide permitted jurisdictions. Put an IP-geolocation layer in front of the service (for example a CDN that supplies a country header), block prohibited locations at sign-up, deposit and staking, and restrict verification to permitted countries of residence.	Launch
3	Planned suppliers not contracted	GAMSTOP, IBAS, eIDV and sanctions/PEP screening	Application / launch as marked
4	Supplier assurance not on file	Collect SOC 2 / ISO 27001 reports or equivalent from Railway, Stripe, Resend, Sentry; record DPAs	Application
5	Third-party fonts	Self-host fonts so no visitor data goes to Google	Recommended

7. Review

The Head of Compliance keeps this map current with engineering. Any new supplier, removal of a supplier, or change of hosting is reviewed before it goes live, reflected here, and assessed as a possible key event (Document 14).

Version	Date	Change
0.1	30 September 2026	First draft

Document 09 — End-to-End Customer and System Flow

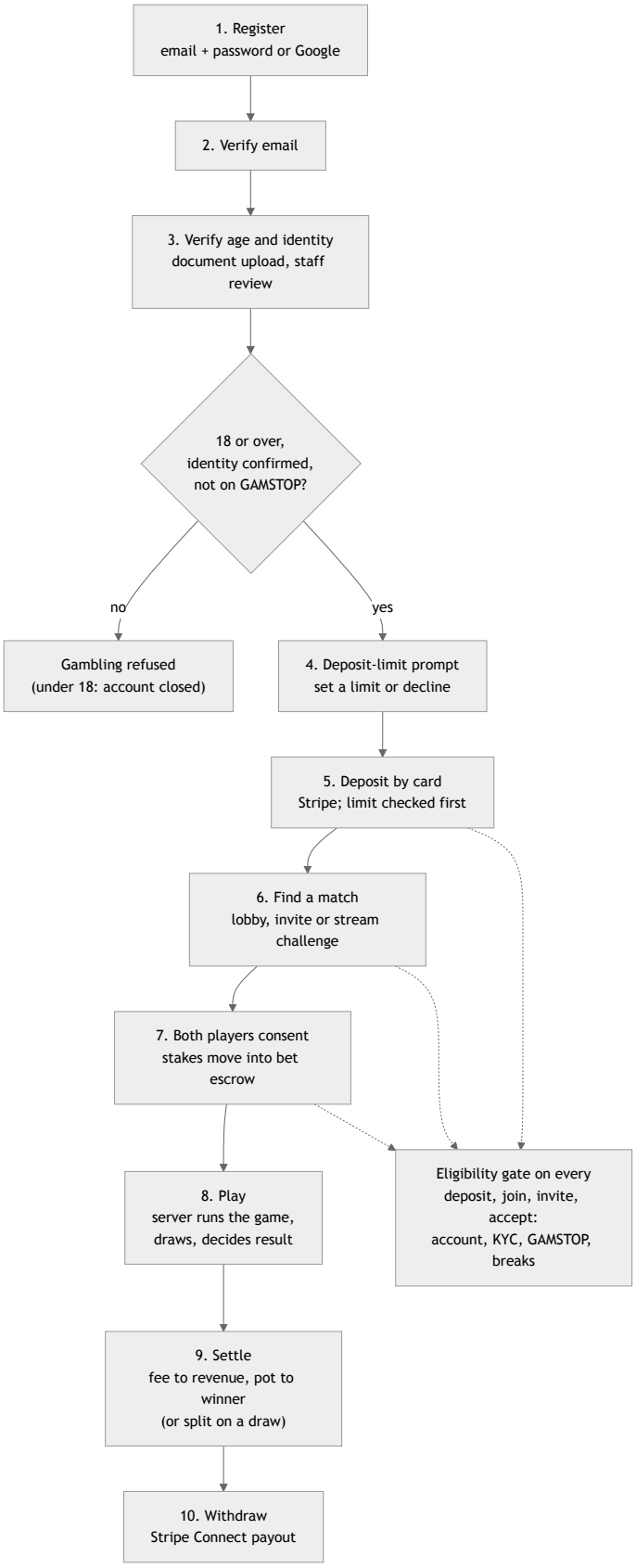
Operator	[COMPANY NAME], trading as PlayStake
Owner	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], Head of Compliance (with engineering)
Version	0.1 — draft for licence application
Review	On any change to registration, verification, payments, games or settlement; at least annually
Relates to	Remote operating licence application: end-to-end diagram including the location of remote gambling equipment; Documents 08 and 10

> Draft prepared from the platform as built on 30 September 2026. `[BRACKETS]` must be completed before submission.

1. Purpose

This document follows a customer from registration to gambling to getting their money out, showing at each step which system does the work, which checks apply, and where the equipment is. Remote gambling equipment in the sense of the Gambling Act 2005 — the servers that register customers, record stakes, decide results and hold the wallet — is the PlayStake web service, worker service and PostgreSQL database, all hosted by Railway in **[RAILWAY REGION]** (Document 10 §3).

2. The journey at a glance



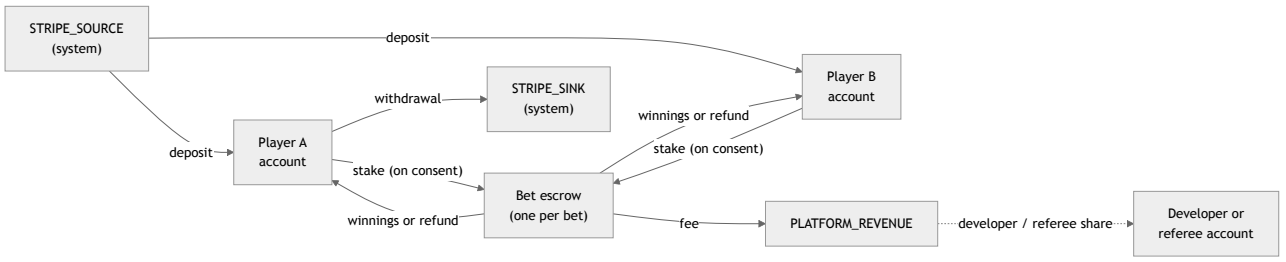
3. Step by step

All PlayStake steps run on the web service or worker service with data in PostgreSQL, hosted by Railway in [RAILWAY REGION], unless another location is given.

Step	What happens	Controls	System and location
1. Register	Customer creates an account with email and password, or signs in with Google. Terms, privacy and 18+ confirmed.	Password strength rules; bcrypt hashing; rate limits on registration and sign-in; lockout after repeated failures	Web service (Railway). Google sign-in: Google.
2. Verify email	A link is emailed. Identity verification can't be started until the email is verified, so nobody can deposit or gamble with an unverified address.	Single-use, expiring token	Email sent through Resend from the worker's outbox
3. Verify age and identity	Customer enters legal name, date of birth and address and uploads an identity document. Staff review it in the admin console.	Documents encrypted (AES-256-GCM) at rest; under-18 dates of birth refused and the account closed; shared-identity check across accounts; every staff view logged; decision and reason recorded. No deposit, free play or gambling before approval.	Web service + PostgreSQL (Railway). Staff access over HTTPS with 2FA.
3a. GAMSTOP *(planned)*	The verified identity is checked against GAMSTOP on verification, on sign-in and when a cached result is over 24 hours old.	Registered customers can't gamble; a failed check refuses gambling rather than allowing it	GAMSTOP API (UK)
4. Deposit-limit prompt	Before the first deposit the customer must set a deposit limit or actively decline. Every six months they are reminded to review limits.	Limits are on gross deposits, per day/week/month; decreases apply at once, increases after 24 hours	Web service (Railway)
5. Deposit	Customer pays by card on a Stripe form. Stripe confirms payment by signed webhook; the ledger then moves funds from `STRIPE_SOURCE` to the player's account.	Eligibility gate; deposit limits (most restrictive applies); affordability and AML thresholds; webhook signature verified; idempotent ledger transfer	Card entry: Stripe. Webhook handling and ledger: Railway.
6. Find a match	Customer joins a game lobby and picks a stake, invites or is invited by another player, or challenges a live streamer. The fee and what a win or draw pays are shown before commitment.	Eligibility gate on join, invite and accept, for both players; lobby entries and invites expire	Web service; real-time lobby events through Redis (Railway)
7. Consent and escrow	Each player explicitly consents. Only then is their stake moved from their account into a per-bet escrow account.	Sufficient-funds check in the same database statement as the debit; no stake taken without consent; unanswered bets expire and refund	Ledger in PostgreSQL (Railway)
8. Play	`/play` games: the server holds the state, draws every random outcome (CSPRNG) and decides the result; each move and draw is written to an append-only event log. Stream matches: an independent referee decides from both streams.	Clients can't declare results; hidden cards never leave the server; a started match left idle 10 minutes is forfeited by the player to move; an unstarted one is voided and refunded	Game server: web service (Railway). Stream video: Kick.

Step	What happens	Controls	System and location
9. Settle	The fee goes to `PLATFORM_REVENUE`, any developer or referee share is paid, and the rest of the escrow goes to the winner (or is split on a draw). Escrow must end at exactly zero.	Stream matches settle only after the dispute window; mismatched results open a dispute; settlement worker takes a row lock; daily ledger audit checks every account and transaction balances	Worker service or web service (Railway)
10. Withdraw	Customer onboards to Stripe Connect Express once, then requests a withdrawal. The ledger debits their balance to `STRIPE_SINK` and Stripe pays out to their bank.	Verified identity required; suspended accounts can't withdraw; self-excluded and GAMSTOP-registered customers **can** withdraw; payout account name to be matched to the verified name	Ledger: Railway. Payout: Stripe.

4. Money flow



Every arrow is one call to the ledger's `transfer()`, which writes one debit and one matching credit and can never leave an account (other than the three system accounts) below zero.

5. Where the equipment is

Component	Provider	Location
Web service (website, API, game server)	Railway	[RAILWAY REGION]
Worker service (settlement, expiry, detection, email, webhooks)	Railway	[RAILWAY REGION]
PostgreSQL (all records, ledger, encrypted KYC documents)	Railway	[RAILWAY REGION]
Database backups	Railway	[BACKUP LOCATION]
Redis (queues, lobby events)	Railway	[RAILWAY REGION]
Card processing and payouts	Stripe	Stripe data centres (EU/US)
Email delivery	Resend	[RESEND REGION]
Error monitoring	Sentry	[SENTRY REGION]
Live video	Kick	Kick

No gambling equipment is located in Great Britain today unless Railway's region is set to one there. The Commission must be told where remote gambling equipment is and of any change (Document 14).

Version	Date	Change
0.1	30 September 2026	First draft

Document 10 — Operational Model Map

Operator	[COMPANY NAME], trading as PlayStake
Owner	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], Head of Compliance
Version	0.1 — draft for licence application
Review	On any change of supplier, location, staff role or activity; at least annually
Relates to	Remote operating licence application: operational model (location, provider and operator of all systems and activities, including key equipment); Documents 08, 09

> Draft prepared from the platform as built on 30 September 2026. `[BRACKETS]` must be completed before submission.

1. Purpose

For every system and every business activity, this map states where it happens, who provides it and who operates it. "Provider" is whoever supplies the system or service. "Operator" is whoever runs it and makes the decisions. Document 08 has the system diagram and the full outsourcing detail.

2. Operating model in one paragraph

PlayStake is operated by [COMPANY NAME] from [OPERATING ADDRESS]. The company builds and runs its own gambling software. The software runs on cloud infrastructure rented from Railway in [RAILWAY REGION]; PlayStake staff deploy and administer it. Payments are processed by Stripe. All customer-facing decisions — verification, limits, interactions, complaints, disputes, suspensions, AML — are made by PlayStake staff through the PlayStake admin console. At launch one person, [COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], holds the compliance, MLRO and operations roles (Master Manual §3).

3. Key equipment

Equipment	Purpose	Provider	Operator	Location
Web service (Next.js, Node 20)	Website, customer and staff interfaces, API, game server (all `/play` game logic and random number generation), payment webhooks	Railway (infrastructure); PlayStake (software)	PlayStake	[RAILWAY REGION]
Worker service (BullMQ)	Settlement, expiry and no-show handling, dispute escalation, harm and anomaly detection, AML scans, ledger audit, email and webhook delivery, session cleanup	Railway; PlayStake	PlayStake	[RAILWAY REGION]

Equipment	Purpose	Provider	Operator	Location
PostgreSQL 16	System of record: accounts, ledger, bets, game sessions and event log, encrypted identity documents, compliance and audit records	Railway	PlayStake	[RAILWAY REGION]
Database backups	Recovery of the system of record	Railway	PlayStake	[BACKUP LOCATION] — confirm backups are enabled and tested (Document 13)
Redis 7	Job queues, real-time lobby events, worker heartbeat	Railway	PlayStake	[RAILWAY REGION]
Domain and DNS (playstake.org)	Customer access	Namecheap	PlayStake	Global DNS
Source code repository and CI	Change control, automated tests, dependency audit, malware scan	GitHub	PlayStake	GitHub (US)
Staff devices	Administration	[COMPANY / STAFF]	PlayStake staff	[STAFF LOCATIONS]

4. Activities

Activity	Where it is done	Provider	Operator	Notes
Customer registration	Web service	PlayStake	PlayStake	Optional Google sign-in (Google)
Age and identity verification	Web service; admin console	PlayStake	PlayStake staff	Planned eIDV supplier to add electronic checks
GAMSTOP checks	Web service → GAMSTOP	GAMSTOP	PlayStake	Planned
Sanctions and PEP screening	Admin console (manual); planned supplier	[SCREENING PROVIDER]	PlayStake (MLRO)	Manual check against OFSI list until contracted
Deposits	Stripe (card capture); web service (ledger)	Stripe	PlayStake	Stripe in test mode until launch
Withdrawals	Web service (ledger); Stripe Connect (payout)	Stripe	PlayStake	
Matchmaking and challenges	Web service, Redis	PlayStake	PlayStake	
Game play and random number generation	Web service	PlayStake	PlayStake	CSPRNG; outcomes decided server-side; event log
Stream-match refereeing	Referee console; Kick video	PlayStake (software); Kick (video)	Independent referees engaged by PlayStake	Referees vetted and audited (Policy 01)
Result verification and disputes	Web service, worker; admin console	PlayStake	PlayStake staff	

Activity	Where it is done	Provider	Operator	Notes
Settlement and payouts to balances	Worker service / web service	PlayStake	PlayStake	
Safer gambling: limits, breaks, reminders, interactions	Web service, worker; admin console	PlayStake	PlayStake staff	Policies 03–05
AML monitoring and case management	Worker; admin console	PlayStake	MLRO	Policy 07
Fraud and anomaly detection	Worker; admin console	PlayStake (Stripe Radar planned)	PlayStake staff	Policy 01
Customer service	Email (admin@playstake.org)	[EMAIL PROVIDER]	PlayStake staff	
Complaints	Website form; admin console	PlayStake	Complaints manager	Policy 02
ADR	IBAS	IBAS	IBAS	To sign
Transactional email	Worker outbox → Resend	Resend	PlayStake	
Marketing	Not carried out	—	—	No affiliates, ads or tracking
Error monitoring and alerting	Sentry; admin email alerts	Sentry	PlayStake	
Ledger audit and reconciliation	Worker (daily 03:00 UTC)	PlayStake	PlayStake	
Software development and release	GitHub → Railway deploy	GitHub, Railway	PlayStake	Tested in CI before release (Document 11)
Security testing	[PEN TEST PROVIDER]; annual security audit	[AUDITOR]	PlayStake	Not yet commissioned (Document 13)
Regulatory reporting	Email / eServices	—	Head of Compliance	Document 14

5. Changes

A change to any location, provider or operator in this map is assessed before it happens. Changes to where remote gambling equipment is located, and to key suppliers, are reported to the Commission as key events where LCCP 15.2.1 requires (Document 14).

Version	Date	Change
0.1	30 September 2026	First draft

Document 11 — Testing Strategy

Operator	[COMPANY NAME], trading as PlayStake
Owner	[ENGINEERING LEAD NAME], with sign-off by [COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], Head of Compliance
Version	0.1 — draft for licence application
Review	Annually; on any new game, change to random number generation, or change to the RTS or testing requirements (Document 12)
Relates to	Remote gambling and software technical standards (RTS), and the Commission's testing strategy requirements for compliance with the RTS; licence condition on gambling software; Documents 12, 13

> Draft prepared from the platform as built on 30 September 2026. `[BRACKETS]` must be completed before submission. RTS paragraph numbers are for orientation and must be confirmed against the current RTS (Document 12). The split between third-party and in-house testing below must be confirmed with the Commission (§3.3).

1. Purpose

This strategy explains how PlayStake makes sure its gambling system meets the RTS before release and stays compliant through every change: what is tested, by whom, when, how it is recorded and who signs it off.

2. What we offer, and what needs testing

Product	Type	Random element	Outcome decided by
Tic-Tac-Toe	Peer-to-peer, pure skill	None	Server applies moves; first line of three wins
Darts 301	Peer-to-peer, skill with chance	Scatter of each dart around the aim point (server CSPRNG, Gaussian)	Server: board scoring, 301 rules, three rounds
Live stream matches	Peer-to-peer, skill, external game	None in PlayStake	Independent human referee, with dispute window

PlayStake does not offer house-banked games; players stake against each other and PlayStake takes a disclosed fee. All game logic and random number generation run on PlayStake's servers (Document 08 §3.1).

> **Note for the application:** Higher / Lower, a card game that was almost entirely chance, was withdrawn on 30 September 2026 so that everything offered fits a betting intermediary licence. Its past match records are kept; no new match can be started.

3. Approach

3.1 Third-party testing (approved test house)

We will engage a Commission-approved test house to test and certify, before real-money launch:

Item	What the test house checks	RTS
Random number generation	`src/lib/games/rng.ts` : Node.js `crypto.randomInt` (OS CSPRNG); unbiased integer draws; the uniform-to-Gaussian conversion (Box–Muller) used for dart scatter; no reuse or predictability; scaling free of modulo bias	RTS 7 (generation of random outcomes)
Darts rules and maths	Board geometry and scoring match the drawn board; scatter model; bust, checkout, three-round and draw rules match the published rules	RTS 3, 6, 7
Game records	Each move, draw and result is logged immutably and can be replayed	RTS 7

Test houses on the Commission's approved list include BMM Testlabs, eCOGRA, Gaming Associates Europe, Gaming Laboratories International (GLI), Global Lab, NFA / Eclipse, Quinel and RiskCherry (check the Commission's current list before engaging). **Selected test house: [TEST HOUSE]. Engagement date: [DATE].** The test house certificate and report are kept with this strategy and supplied to the Commission on request.

3.2 In-house testing

PlayStake tests everything else itself, under this strategy, with results recorded:

Area	How we test it	RTS
Customer information: rules, fees, payouts shown before commitment	Manual review against the game code at each release; screenshots kept	RTS 3
Safer gambling tools: deposit limits (gross, most restrictive applies), 24-hour delay on increases, first-deposit prompt, six-monthly review, breaks, reality checks, clock/elapsed time	Automated integration tests; manual check each release	RTS 12, 13, 14
Interrupted and abandoned games	Automated tests: void of unstarted matches, forfeit by the player to move, settlement of finished-but-unsettled matches	RTS 10
Collusion, cheating, bots	Controls reviewed each release; server-side outcomes proven by tests that reject client-declared results	RTS 11, 16
Ledger and escrow integrity	Automated tests of `transfer()` , escrow netting to zero, conservation; database triggers make entries append-only; daily production audit	Licence conditions on customer funds; RTS security requirements
Eligibility gate: KYC, GAMSTOP, breaks, account status	Automated tests	RTS 12, 14
Security controls	Document 13; independent penetration test; annual security audit	RTS security requirements

3.3 Points to confirm with the Commission

- Whether any RTS test requirement applies differently to peer-to-peer skill games where PlayStake is not a party to the bet.
- Whether a test house must also cover the platform functions listed in §3.2, or whether an in-house declaration is acceptable for them.

4. Automated testing on every change

- Every change goes through GitHub. CI runs lint, a type check, a dependency vulnerability audit (fails on critical findings), a malware scan and the full test suite against real PostgreSQL and Redis. A change can't be released unless CI passes.
- The suite (368 tests on 30 September 2026) includes, among others:
  - `tests/unit/ledger/` — double-entry transfers, escrow, audit invariants
  - `tests/unit/games/darts.test.ts` — board scoring matches the drawn board, bust, checkout, three-round result, draws
  - `tests/integration/game-integrity.test.ts` — only the server decides, declared results refused, event log is complete and append-only, darts scoring, sweep forfeits and settles correctly
  - `tests/integration/demo-hardening.test.ts` — no player can forge a session or settle someone else's bet
  - `tests/integration/compliance-gates.test.ts`, `limit-review.test.ts`, `session-idle.test.ts`, and the responsible-play, KYC, AML and complaints suites

5. Change control

Change class	Examples	Testing before release	Sign-off
Major	New game; any change to `rng.ts`, tic-tac-toe or darts rules, board geometry, the scatter model; change to fee or settlement arithmetic	Full automated suite; test-house re-test and new certificate for game/RNG changes; update rules shown to customers	Engineering lead + Head of Compliance; test-house certificate on file
Standard	Changes to safer-gambling tools, limits, eligibility, payments, ledger	Full automated suite plus new tests for the change; manual check of customer-facing text	Engineering lead + Head of Compliance
Minor	Copy, styling, non-gambling pages	Full automated suite	Engineering lead
Emergency	Security fix	Full automated suite; retrospective review within 5 working days	Engineering lead; Head of Compliance informed same day

Each release records: the commit, the CI run, the change class, any test-house reference, and sign-off. Game and RNG software versions are identified by the git commit of `src/lib/games/`.

6. Monitoring in production

- **Game fairness:** every draw is in `game_events`. A monthly statistical check (dart-scatter distribution against expectation) is to be run and recorded. [TO BUILD — outstanding item.]

- **Ledger:** the ledger-audit worker verifies every account, every transaction and system-wide conservation daily and alerts on any failure.
- **Results:** the anomaly worker flags skewed win rates, single-winner patterns, fast settlements and volume spikes.

7. Annual security audit

The RTS security requirements call for an independent annual security audit against the ISO/IEC 27001:2022 controls listed in Document 13. For a new licensee the first audit is due within **six months of the licence being granted**, then each year. The auditor must be independent and suitably qualified (for example ISO/IEC 27001 Lead Auditor, CISA, CISM or CISSP). The report goes to the Commission at securityaudit@gamblingcommission.gov.uk. Auditor: [AUDITOR]. First audit due: [GRANT DATE + 6 MONTHS].

8. Records

Test-house certificates and reports, CI results, release sign-offs, the monthly fairness check, and security audit reports are kept for at least five years.

Version	Date	Change
0.1	30 September 2026	First draft

Document 12 — RTS Compliance Statement and Change Register

Operator	[COMPANY NAME], trading as PlayStake
Owner	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], Head of Compliance
Version	0.1 — draft for licence application
Review	Monthly check of the Commission's RTS pages; full review annually
Relates to	Remote gambling and software technical standards (RTS); Documents 11, 13

> Draft prepared from the platform as built on 30 September 2026. RTS references are for orientation and must be confirmed against the Commission's current published text before submission. Items marked **confirm** depend on the Commission's view of which requirements apply to peer-to-peer play.

1. Purpose

This document states how PlayStake meets each RTS requirement that applies to it, and keeps a register of changes to the RTS so that none is missed. Testing of these controls is covered in Document 11; the RTS security requirements in Document 13.

2. How we track RTS changes

- The Head of Compliance checks the Commission's RTS pages, news and consultation responses **monthly** and records the check in §5, even when nothing has changed.
- Each change is entered in the register (§4) with its effective date, what it means for PlayStake, the work needed, an owner and a target date at least one month before it takes effect.
- Work is delivered through the change control in Document 11 §5 and the register is updated with the release and evidence.
- We also subscribe to the Commission's email updates and review industry updates from our compliance adviser.

3. Compliance statement

Topic	RTS ref (confirm)	Applies?	How PlayStake meets it	Evidence
Rules, game descriptions and likelihood of winning	RTS 3	Yes	Each game's page shows full rules before joining, including tie and draw rules; the Fair Play page summarises all games; darts explains that scatter is random	`src/components/games/game-config.ts`, `/fair-play`

Topic	RTS ref (confirm)	Applies?	How PlayStake meets it	Evidence
Fees and what a customer can win	RTS 3 / LCCP	Yes	Fee %, fee amount, win payout and draw return shown on the stake picker, invites and challenges before commitment, using the same arithmetic as settlement	`src/components/lobby/PayoutSummary.tsx`, `src/lib/utils/payout.ts`
Display of results and records	RTS 5 / 6	Yes	Server-decided results shown to both players; bet history and bet detail pages; append-only game event log	`game_events` table
Generation of random outcomes	RTS 7	Yes (Darts)	Server-side CSPRNG (`crypto.randomInt`), unbiased draws; each draw logged. Test-house certification before launch.	`src/lib/games/rng.ts`; Document 11 §3.1
Interrupted and abandoned gambling	RTS 10	Yes	State saved after every move; players can rejoin. Unstarted matches void with full refund after 10 min; started matches idle 10 min forfeited by the player to move; finished-unsettled matches settled on the record; our faults reviewed and voided or corrected. Published on `/fair-play`.	`src/workers/bet-expiry.worker.ts`; tests
Anti-collusion and cheating; recovered funds policy	RTS 11	Yes	Outcomes decided server-side; anomaly and shared-identity detection; cheating, collusion and bots prohibited; published policy on suspending accounts, voiding matches, returning stakes to affected players and informing them	`/fair-play` §§5–6; Policy 01
Financial limits	RTS 12	Yes	See §3.1	

Topic	RTS ref (confirm)	Applies?	How PlayStake meets it	Evidence
Time: clock or elapsed time; reality checks	RTS 13	Yes	Current time and session length always on screen on `/play`, including mobile fullscreen. Optional reality checks at a customer-chosen interval showing time, stakes and net result.	`SessionClock.tsx`, `SessionReminder.tsx`
Breaks in play and self-exclusion	RTS 14 (updated 12 Jan 2026 — **review changes**)	Yes	Cool-off and self-exclusion breaks that can't be shortened; withdrawal still allowed; return from self-exclusion needs a request and a 24-hour cooling-off; GAMSTOP (planned)	Policies 03, 04
Third-party software and bots	RTS 16	Yes	Automation prohibited in terms and Fair Play; aim and hold are the only skill inputs and are bounded server-side; detection by pattern review	`/fair-play` §5
Auto-play, game speed, near-miss and similar slot/casino design rules	Various	**Confirm** — likely not applicable to peer-to-peer skill games	No auto-play; each action is a deliberate player input; no spin-style features	—
Security requirements	RTS security section (ISO/IEC 27001:2022)	Yes	Document 13	Document 13

3.1 RTS 12 financial limits

Requirement	Effective	Status
Prompt to set a deposit limit at registration or before first deposit, with limit-setting presented as the default	31 October 2025	**Met.** First deposit is blocked until the customer sets a limit or actively declines; the answer is recorded. **Check** that setting a limit is the visually primary option in the prompt.

Requirement	Effective	Status
Remind customers at least every six months to review their limits	31 October 2025	**Met** (built 30 September 2026). Six-monthly reminder in the dashboard and `/play`; answering, or changing a limit, restarts the period.
Increases to limits take effect only after a cooling-off period of at least 24 hours; decreases immediately	31 October 2025	**Met.** Increases and removals are staged for 24 hours.
Gross deposit limits must be offered as a minimum	**30 September 2026** (postponed from 30 June 2026)	**Met.** Limits count all deposits, pending and completed, without netting off withdrawals.
Only a gross deposit limit may be called a "deposit limit"; other limit types must be named accurately	30 September 2026	**Met.** The only financial limit offered is a gross deposit limit.
Where limits over several timeframes are set, the most restrictive applies	30 September 2026	**Met.** Every daily, weekly and monthly limit is checked on each deposit; the first one breached blocks it.
Definitions of stake, loss and net-deposit limits; equal prominence of limit types	30 September 2026	**Not applicable today** — no stake, loss or net-deposit limits are offered. If any is added, it must follow the definitions and be given equal prominence.

4. RTS change register

Date published	Change	Effective	Impact on PlayStake	Action	Owner	Status
31 Oct 2025	RTS index updated; RTS 12 financial limits changes (phase 1)	31 Oct 2025	First-deposit limit prompt, six-monthly review, 24-hour increase delay	Built; six-monthly reminder added 30 Sep 2026	Head of Compliance	Done
[DATE]	RTS 12 phase 2: gross deposit limits, naming, most restrictive timeframe, definitions, equal prominence	Originally 30 Jun 2026, **postponed to 30 Sep 2026**	Deposit limits already gross and all timeframes enforced	Confirmed compliant 30 Sep 2026 (§3.1)	Head of Compliance	Done
12 Jan 2026	RTS 14 updated	[CONFIRM]	Breaks and self-exclusion tools	Review the updated text against Policies 03 and 04 and record the outcome	Head of Compliance	**Open**
29 Jan 2026	Consultation response on gaming machine technical standards (GMTS)	[N/A]	None: PlayStake offers no gaming machines. This was not an RTS change.	None	Head of Compliance	Closed

Date published	Change	Effective	Impact on PlayStake	Action	Owner	Status
[DATE]	RTS security requirements move to ISO/IEC 27001:2022 control references	[CONFIRM]	Security control mapping	Document 13 maps to the 2022 controls	Head of Compliance	Done

5. Monthly check log

Month	Checked by	RTS pages changed?	Register updated?
September 2026	[NAME]	See register	Yes

Version	Date	Change
0.1	30 September 2026	First draft

Document 13 — Information Security Policy (RTS security requirements)

Operator	[COMPANY NAME], trading as PlayStake
Owner	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], Head of Compliance, as Information Security Officer until a dedicated role is appointed; [ENGINEERING LEAD NAME] for technical controls
Version	0.1 — draft for licence application
Review	Annually; after any security incident; after the annual security audit
Relates to	RTS security requirements (ISO/IEC 27001:2022 controls named by the Commission); LCCP 15.2.1 key events; UK GDPR; Documents 08, 11, 14

> Draft prepared from the platform as built on 30 September 2026. Status reflects what exists in the code and configuration today. "Partial" and "Planned" items are listed in §6 with owners. `[BRACKETS]` must be completed before submission.

1. Policy statement

PlayStake protects customer funds, customer data and the integrity of its games. We base our information security management on ISO/IEC 27001:2022 and meet, as a minimum, the controls the Commission's RTS security requirements name. The controls apply to every system that handles customer data, money or game outcomes: the web and worker services, the database, the admin console, and the suppliers in Document 08.

We commit to:

- a named owner for information security with authority to stop a release or suspend a service;
- controls proportionate to risk, reviewed at least annually;
- an independent security audit every year, the first within six months of licence grant (Document 11 §7);
- reporting security incidents to the Commission and the ICO when required (Document 14).

2. Scope

In scope	Notes
Web service, worker service, PostgreSQL, Redis (Railway)	All customer data, the ledger and game logic
Admin console and staff accounts	Privileged access
Source code, CI and deployment pipeline (GitHub → Railway)	Integrity of released software
Suppliers handling customer data (Stripe, Resend, Sentry, GAMSTOP, IBAS, eIDV)	Through supplier management (5.19–5.23)
Staff devices used for administration	Endpoint controls (8.1)

3. Key technical safeguards

- **Money:** double-entry ledger; only `transfer()` changes balances; sufficient-funds check in the same SQL statement as the debit; idempotency keys; ledger entries append-only by database trigger; daily automated audit of every account and transaction.
- **Games:** every outcome decided on the server with a CSPRNG; hidden information never sent to clients; append-only game event log.
- **Identity and access:** passwords hashed with bcrypt (cost 12); sign-in rate limits and lockout; session tokens random, stored only as SHA-256 hashes, 7-day lifetime and 30-minute idle timeout; staff require TOTP two-factor authentication (enforced in production); role-based access checked on every admin route.
- **Data protection:** identity documents encrypted with AES-256-GCM; Kick OAuth tokens encrypted under a separate key; card data never touches PlayStake (Stripe Elements); all traffic over HTTPS with HSTS.
- **Web application:** input validation (Zod) on all API routes; Content-Security-Policy; framing blocked except for the embeddable widget; `nosniff`, strict referrer policy, restrictive permissions policy; identity-document responses sandboxed and never cached.
- **Integrations:** Stripe and Kick webhooks verified by signature; outbound webhooks to developers signed with HMAC-SHA256; constant-time comparison of secrets.
- **Audit:** every privileged staff action (including each view of an identity document) is written to an append-only admin audit log with actor, target, change and IP address.

4. Control mapping — ISO/IEC 27001:2022

Status: **In place** — implemented and evidenced; **Partial** — some of the control exists, gap in §6; **Planned** — not yet in place.

4.1 Organisational controls

Control	How PlayStake meets it	Status
5.1 Policies for information security	This policy, approved by the board and reviewed annually	Partial — board approval pending
5.10 Acceptable use of information and assets	Staff acceptable-use rules: admin console only from managed devices, no customer data in personal tools, no sharing of accounts	Planned — write and sign
5.15 Access control	Roles (PLAYER, DEVELOPER, ADMIN, plus approved referee status) enforced server-side on every route; least privilege for staff	In place
5.16 Identity management	One named account per person; no shared admin accounts; accounts closed on leaving	In place (process)
5.17 Authentication information	bcrypt password hashing; TOTP 2FA for staff; secrets only in Railway environment variables, never in code	In place
5.18 Access rights	Staff access granted by the Head of Compliance, recorded, and reviewed quarterly; infrastructure (Railway, GitHub, Stripe) access reviewed at the same time	Partial — first review to schedule
5.19 Information security in supplier relationships	Suppliers assessed before use (Document 08 §4)	Partial — assurance reports to collect

Control	How PlayStake meets it	Status
5.20 Addressing security within supplier agreements	DPAs and security terms in each supplier contract	Partial — confirm DPAs on file
5.21 Managing security in the ICT supply chain	Dependabot updates; CI dependency audit fails on critical vulnerabilities; malware scan on every push and weekly; lockfile-pinned installs (`npm ci`)	In place
5.22 Monitoring and review of supplier services	Annual supplier review; incident notifications from suppliers assessed under Document 14	Planned
5.23 Information security for use of cloud services	Railway project access limited to named staff with 2FA; region and backups recorded	Partial — region, backups (§6)
5.24 Incident management planning and preparation	Document 14	In place (document)
5.25 Assessment and decision on information security events	Triage in Document 14 §3	In place (document)
5.26 Response to information security incidents	Document 14 §4	In place (document)
5.28 Collection of evidence	Append-only audit logs, ledger and game events; log export and preservation steps in Document 14	Partial — log retention (§6)
5.35 Independent review of information security	Annual independent security audit; quarterly review by external compliance adviser	Planned

4.2 People controls

Control	How PlayStake meets it	Status
6.3 Awareness, education and training	Security training on joining and annually, recorded with safer-gambling and AML training (Master Manual §5.4)	Planned
6.5 Responsibilities after termination or change of employment	Leaver checklist: close admin account, remove Railway/GitHub/Stripe access, rotate any shared secrets the person could see	Planned — write checklist
6.7 Remote working	Administration only from managed devices with disk encryption and screen lock, over HTTPS with 2FA	Partial — device standard to document
6.8 Information security event reporting	Anyone who spots a possible incident reports it at once to the Information Security Officer (Document 14 §2)	In place (document)

4.3 Physical controls

PlayStake operates no data centre or office servers; physical security of hosting is provided by Railway and its infrastructure providers.

Control	How PlayStake meets it	Status
7.8 Equipment siting and protection	Hosting provider's data-centre controls, evidenced by its assurance report	Partial — report to collect

Control	How PlayStake meets it	Status
7.10 Storage media	No customer data on removable media; exports only when necessary, encrypted, and deleted after use	Planned — write rule
7.14 Secure disposal or re-use of equipment	Staff devices wiped before disposal or re-use; provider handles hosting media	Planned — write rule

4.4 Technological controls

Control	How PlayStake meets it	Status
8.1 User endpoint devices	Staff devices: full-disk encryption, OS updates, screen lock, password manager	Partial — to document and check
8.2 Privileged access rights	ADMIN role limited to named staff; 2FA enforced; all admin actions audit-logged; production database access limited to named engineers through Railway	In place
8.3 Information access restriction	Customers see only their own data; bet and game data limited to participants; identity documents only to admins, streamed decrypted per request and logged	In place
8.5 Secure authentication	Rate-limited sign-in and lockout; session tokens hashed; 30-minute idle timeout; 7-day absolute lifetime; staff 2FA	In place
8.7 Protection against malware	CI malware scan; dependency audit; no file execution from uploads; identity documents served sandboxed with `nosniff`; removed a disguised HTML file from public assets (30 Sep 2026)	In place
8.13 Information backup	Railway PostgreSQL backups	**Planned — confirm enabled, set retention, test a restore**
8.15 Logging	Structured JSON logs from web and worker; admin audit log; ledger and game event logs; Sentry error reports	Partial — log retention period and access to be set
8.17 Clock synchronisation	Hosts synchronised by the provider; the application records times in UTC	Partial — database columns store times without time zone (UTC by convention); migrate to `timestamptz`
8.18 Use of privileged utility programs	Direct database access (Prisma Studio, psql) only for named engineers, for a recorded reason; money never changed outside `transfer()`	Partial — record usage
8.20 Networks security	Database and Redis reachable only on Railway's private network [CONFIRM no public database proxy]; all public traffic over HTTPS	Partial — confirm
8.21 Security of network services	TLS on all endpoints; HSTS; webhook signatures	In place
8.22 Segregation of networks	Production separate from development and CI; services communicate over Railway's private network	Partial — confirm
8.24 Use of cryptography	AES-256-GCM for identity documents and OAuth tokens with separate keys; bcrypt; SHA-256 token hashes; HMAC-SHA256 webhook signing; TLS. Keys held only in the hosting environment; key rotation procedure to write	Partial — rotation procedure

Control	How PlayStake meets it	Status
8.25 Secure development life cycle	All changes in Git; CI lint, type check, tests, dependency audit and malware scan before release; change classes and sign-off (Document 11 §5)	In place
8.26 Application security requirements	Server-side authorisation on every route; identity from session only, never the request body; input validation; idempotency on money routes	In place
8.27 Secure system architecture and engineering principles	Ledger as trust boundary; server-authoritative games; append-only records; fail-closed eligibility gate	In place
8.29 Security testing in development and acceptance	Automated tests for authorisation and exploit paths (e.g. forged sessions, client-declared results); independent penetration test before launch and annually	Partial — penetration test not yet done
8.30 Outsourced development	None at present; any future outsourced development under the same CI and review	In place
8.31 Separation of development, test and production environments	Local and CI environments use their own databases; production secrets never in development	In place
8.32 Change management	Document 11 §5	In place
8.33 Test information	Tests create their own synthetic data; production data is never copied into test	In place

5. Known residual risks (accepted, with review date)

Risk	Why accepted for now	Review
High-severity advisories in the Prisma CLI toolchain (`@prisma/dev`, `mysql2`, `deepmerge-ts`, `find-my-way`)	Development/migration tooling, not used to serve requests; the only fix offered is a major-version downgrade. Tracked by Dependabot.	Monthly
Content-Security-Policy allows inline scripts	Needed by the Next.js runtime; move to per-request nonces	Before launch
Rate limits held in each web process's memory	Correct with one web instance; must move to Redis before scaling out	Before running two web instances

6. Gaps and actions

#	Action	Control	Owner	Due
1	Confirm Railway backups are enabled, set retention, and test a restore; record the result	8.13	Engineering	Before launch
2	Set log retention and access; export logs to durable storage	8.15, 5.28	Engineering	Before launch
3	Commission an independent penetration test and fix findings	8.29	Head of Compliance	Before launch

#	Action	Control	Owner	Due
4	Appoint the annual security auditor; first audit within 6 months of grant	5.35	Head of Compliance	Grant + 6 months
5	Write acceptable use, leaver checklist, device standard, media and disposal rules; staff sign them	5.10, 6.5, 6.7, 7.10, 7.14, 8.1	Head of Compliance	Application
6	Collect supplier assurance reports and DPAs	5.19–5.23, 7.8	Head of Compliance	Application
7	Migrate timestamp columns to `timestamptz`	8.17	Engineering	Within 3 months
8	Key rotation procedure for encryption and signing keys	8.24	Engineering	Before launch
9	Move rate limiting to Redis	8.5	Engineering	Before scaling
10	Nonce-based CSP	8.26	Engineering	Before launch
11	Confirm database and Redis are not publicly reachable	8.20, 8.22	Engineering	Application
12	Quarterly access review of admin, Railway, GitHub and Stripe accounts	5.18	Head of Compliance	Quarterly from launch

Version	Date	Change
0.1	30 September 2026	First draft

Document 14 — Incident Response and Key Event Reporting

Operator	[COMPANY NAME], trading as PlayStake
Owner	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], Head of Compliance and Information Security Officer
Version	0.1 — draft for licence application
Review	Annually; after every Severity 1 or 2 incident; after a test exercise
Relates to	LCCP 15.2.1 (reporting key events); LCCP 15.2.2 (other reportable events); RTS security requirements (ISO/IEC 27001:2022 5.24–5.28, 6.8); UK GDPR Articles 33–34; Proceeds of Crime Act 2002; Document 13

> Draft prepared from the platform as built on 30 September 2026. The key event list in §6 must be checked against the current LCCP before submission. `[BRACKETS]` must be completed.

1. Purpose

This procedure sets out how PlayStake spots, handles, records and reports incidents that threaten customer funds, customer data, game fairness or the availability of the service, and how we meet our duty to report key events to the Gambling Commission.

2. Reporting an incident

Anyone — staff, a referee, a supplier or a customer — who sees something that may be an incident reports it straight away to the Information Security Officer (ISO): [PHONE], [EMAIL], and in the operations channel. Customers report through admin@playstake.org or the complaints form; support passes anything security-related to the ISO at once. Don't investigate alone, delete anything, or contact a suspected attacker.

Automatic triggers:

- ledger-audit worker failure (a balance or transaction that doesn't reconcile) — email alert to `EMAIL_ADMIN`;
- worker heartbeat missing (`/api/health` reports the worker down);
- error spikes in Sentry;
- anomaly, AML or player-risk alerts;
- supplier incident notices (Stripe, Railway, Resend, Kick, GAMSTOP).

3. Triage

The ISO decides severity within 1 hour of the report and records it in the incident register (§8).

Severity	Examples	Response
1 — Critical	Customer funds wrong or at risk; ledger doesn't reconcile; confirmed data breach; unauthorised admin access; a game deciding results wrongly; service unavailable to customers for more than 1 hour	Incident lead appointed at once; board informed within 4 hours; work continues until contained

Severity	Examples	Response
2 — High	Suspected breach under investigation; fault affecting some customers' bets or limits; safer-gambling tool not working (limits, breaks, GAMSTOP check); supplier outage stopping deposits or withdrawals	Incident lead appointed same day; board informed within 24 hours
3 — Medium	Degraded performance; isolated bug with no money or data impact; blocked attack attempt	Handled in normal work; reviewed weekly
4 — Low	Near miss; policy breach without impact	Logged; reviewed monthly

A fault in a safer-gambling control is always at least Severity 2, and gambling for affected customers is stopped until it's fixed.

4. Response steps

1. **Contain.** Stop the harm first. Options, in order of preference:
   - suspend affected accounts (`/admin/users`);
   - turn off the affected feature or game (remove from `/play`, disable deposits by removing the payments flag);
   - stop the worker service if it is moving money wrongly;
   - put the web service into maintenance, or scale it to zero, in Railway;
   - rotate compromised secrets (Railway environment variables) and sign all users out (delete sessions).
2. **Preserve evidence.** Don't change or delete records. The ledger, game events and admin audit log are append-only. Export relevant application logs from Railway and Sentry before they age out; take a database snapshot; record every action taken, with times, in the incident record.
3. **Assess.** Which customers, how much money, what data, since when, and how. Use the ledger audit, game event log and admin audit log to establish the facts.
4. **Fix and recover.** Deploy the fix through CI (emergency change class, Document 11 §5). Restore from backup only if needed and only after preserving evidence. Correct any wrong payment with a new, reversing ledger transfer — never by editing records.
5. **Tell the people who need to know** (§5 and §6).
6. **Close and learn.** Within 10 working days of containment, a post-incident review records the cause, the impact, what worked, what didn't, and actions with owners. Policies, controls and tests are updated.

5. Notifying customers and others

Who	When	How
Affected customers	When their money, bets or data are affected. For a personal data breach likely to cause high risk, without undue delay (UK GDPR Art. 34).	Email and in-app message: what happened, what it means for them, what we've done, what they should do
Information Commissioner's Office	Personal data breach likely to risk people's rights and freedoms: **within 72 hours** of becoming aware (UK GDPR Art. 33)	ICO breach reporting service
Stripe	Suspected compromise of payment flows or Stripe credentials	Stripe support; rotate keys
National Crime Agency	Suspected money laundering or terrorist financing	Suspicious Activity Report by the MLRO (Policy 07)

Who	When	How
Police / Action Fraud	Suspected crime, e.g. fraud or unauthorised access	Report online; record reference
Suppliers	Incident involving their service	Supplier's incident route
IBAS	Only as part of a customer's complaint	—

6. Key events: reporting to the Gambling Commission

LCCP 15.2.1 requires the Commission to be told of key events **as soon as reasonably practicable and in any event within five working days** of PlayStake becoming aware of them. Reports are made through the Commission's eServices portal by the Head of Compliance, who keeps a copy with the incident record.

Key events most relevant to PlayStake (check the full list in the current LCCP):

Key event	Example for PlayStake
A breach of information security that affects the confidentiality of customer data, or that stops customers accessing the gambling system for **more than 12 hours**	Leak of KYC documents; database exposed; outage over 12 hours
A fault in gambling software or systems that causes wrong payouts or losses to customers	Game deciding a wrong winner; settlement paying the wrong amount; limit not applied
Any change to where remote gambling equipment is located, or to the gambling software used	Moving Railway region or provider (Documents 08, 10)
Appointment or loss of key suppliers or significant changes to outsourcing	Change of payment provider or hosting
Criminal investigation or proceedings, or regulatory action elsewhere, involving PlayStake or its key people	—
Material financial events (e.g. insolvency, breach of banking covenants, significant loss)	—
Changes to key people, ownership or control	Change of Head of Compliance / MLRO
Suspected cheating or match-fixing involving customers that has led to action	Collusion ring found and accounts closed

Other events under LCCP 15.2.2 (for example suspicion of offences, or information that may be relevant to the Commission) are reported as that condition requires.

What each report contains: what happened and when; when we became aware; customers, money and data affected; what we've done to contain and fix it; customer communications; further actions and dates; contact person.

7. Playbooks

Incident	First actions
Ledger audit fails	Stop the worker; identify the transaction(s); compare `balance` with the entry sum; no manual balance edits; correct with reversing transfers after sign-off; Severity 1

Incident	First actions
Game decides a wrong result	Remove the game from `/play`; list affected matches from `game_events`; void or correct with reversing transfers; tell affected customers; key event if payouts were wrong; test-house re-test before re-enabling
Leaked secret (API key, encryption key, database URL)	Rotate in Railway; redeploy; delete all sessions; review audit and access logs for use; for the KYC key, re-encrypt documents under a new key
Unauthorised admin access	Suspend the admin account; delete its sessions; review the admin audit log for every action; reverse unauthorised changes; reset 2FA
Outage	Check Railway status and `/api/health`; communicate on the site; if customers can't access the system for more than 12 hours, report as a key event
Safer-gambling tool failure	Stop gambling for affected customers (suspend or pause the feature); fix; review whether anyone gambled who shouldn't have and refund where appropriate
Supplier breach (e.g. Resend, Sentry)	Get facts from the supplier; assess what PlayStake data was involved; follow §5 and §6

8. Incident register

Every incident, including near misses, is recorded: reference, date and time reported, reporter, severity, description, customers/money/data affected, actions and times, notifications made (with references and times), root cause, lessons and actions, date closed. Kept for at least five years and reviewed at each quarterly compliance meeting.

9. Testing this procedure

A tabletop exercise is run at least annually (for example, a simulated KYC data leak and a simulated wrong-payout game fault), recorded, and used to update this document.

Version	Date	Change
0.1	30 September 2026	First draft

Document 15 — UAE (GCGRA) Technical Standards and Certification Plan

Operator	[COMPANY NAME], trading as PlayStake
Owner	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], Head of Compliance, with [ENGINEERING LEAD NAME]
Version	0.1 — planning draft
Review	Before any UAE engagement; on any GCGRA publication
Relates to	UAE General Commercial Gaming Regulatory Authority (GCGRA) requirements; GLI standards series; Documents 11, 12, 13

> **Planning draft, not verified against primary sources.** The GCGRA website could not be accessed when this was prepared. Everything below about GCGRA requirements, licence categories, approved standards and approved laboratories comes from public secondary reporting and must be confirmed directly with the GCGRA and UAE legal counsel before any decision is taken. Gambling is otherwise prohibited in the UAE; nothing may be offered to UAE residents until PlayStake (or a partner) is licensed by the GCGRA.

1. Purpose

To set out what PlayStake would need to do to have its gambling system assessed and certified for the UAE market, reusing as much as possible of the UK work in Documents 11–13.

2. What we understand today (to confirm)

Topic	Current understanding	Source status
Regulator	GCGRA, a federal authority set up in 2023 to license and regulate commercial gaming in the UAE	Secondary reporting
Online gambling	The GCGRA licenses internet gaming and sports wagering; the first such licence was reported in November 2025 (Play 971)	Secondary reporting
Peer-to-peer skill wagering	**Unknown** whether a licence category exists for a platform like PlayStake, or whether it must operate through, or supply, an existing licensee	To ask GCGRA
Technical standards	GCGRA technical standards are reported to be based on the GLI standards series, in particular **GLI-19** (Interactive Gaming Systems) and **GLI-33** (Event Wagering Systems), with GCGRA-specific requirements on top	Secondary reporting
Independent test laboratories	Reported as Gaming Laboratories International (GLI) and BMM Testlabs (BMM North America and BMM Spain)	Secondary reporting
Data location, currency, identity	Not yet known. Likely requirements to check: hosting or data residency in the UAE, AED accounts, UAE identity verification (e.g. Emirates ID / UAE Pass), UAE-only geolocation	To ask GCGRA

3. Which standards are likely to apply

Standard	Why it may apply	Main areas it covers
GLI-19 Interactive Gaming Systems	PlayStake is an online platform with player accounts, a wallet and server-side games	Player account management, KYC and geolocation, wallet and financial transactions, responsible gaming tools, game fairness and RNG, game recall and interrupted games, logging and reporting, security and change management
GLI-33 Event Wagering Systems	Stream matches are wagers on the outcome of an external event (a live game), settled on a referee's result	Wager acceptance, event and result management, settlement, voids and cancellations
GLI RNG requirements (within GLI-19)	Darts uses server-side random draws	RNG source, scaling, seeding, statistical testing
GCGRA-specific requirements	Local rules on responsible gaming, AML, data and reporting	[TO OBTAIN]

4. Plan

Phase	What	Output	Indicative timing
1. Confirm the route	Legal counsel in the UAE; formal enquiry to the GCGRA on whether and how peer-to-peer skill wagering can be licensed; whether PlayStake would apply itself or supply a licensee (B2B)	Written answer and chosen route	Month 1–2
2. Obtain the rules	Get the GCGRA technical standards, licensing rules and any lab-submission guidance; confirm which GLI standards and versions apply	Requirements library	Month 2
3. Gap assessment	Map each requirement to the platform, reusing the UK RTS statement (Document 12), testing strategy (Document 11) and ISO 27001 mapping (Document 13). Early candidates: UAE geolocation; UAE identity checks; AED currency; data residency; GCGRA reporting feeds; game recall display; any limits or tools the GCGRA mandates	Gap register with owners	Month 3
4. Build	Close the gaps as a UAE configuration of the same platform, behind jurisdiction settings, through the change control in Document 11 §5	Release candidate	Months 4–6
5. Lab engagement	Engage GLI or BMM (as approved by the GCGRA). Pre-submission meeting; submit source code, documentation and a test environment; RNG and game certification; platform (GLI-19 / GLI-33) testing	Lab report and certificate	Months 6–9
6. Licence submission	Submit certificates with the licence application or the partner's change notification	Approval	After phase 5
7. Ongoing	Re-certification for changes as the GCGRA requires; keep one change register covering UK and UAE; annual security audit covering both	Maintained certification	Continuous

5. What carries over from the UK work

- **Server-authoritative games and CSPRNG** (`src/lib/games/`), with an append-only event log for game recall — the core of GLI-19 game and RNG testing.
- **Double-entry ledger and per-bet escrow**, append-only, audited daily — the core of wallet and financial transaction requirements.
- **Safer gambling tools** (deposit limits, breaks, reality checks, clock, interactions) and the single eligibility gate.
- **Security controls** mapped to ISO/IEC 27001:2022 (Document 13), and the incident process (Document 14).
- **Test evidence:** the automated test suite and the UK test-house report. Ask the lab whether any UK certification work can be reused, for example for the RNG, to shorten the UAE assessment.

6. Decisions and risks

Item	Note
Licence route	The biggest uncertainty; everything else depends on it
Data residency	If UAE hosting is required, PlayStake needs a second deployment in a UAE region, not just configuration. This changes Documents 08–10.
Choice of lab	Choosing the same lab for the UK and UAE (GLI or BMM are on both lists) may reduce cost and time

7. Next actions

1. Instruct UAE counsel and send the GCGRA enquiry. Owner: Head of Compliance.
2. Ask GLI and BMM for a scoping call covering both UK RTS testing and UAE certification. Owner: Head of Compliance.
3. Obtain the current GLI-19 and GLI-33 standards and start the gap register. Owner: Engineering.

Version	Date	Change
0.1	30 September 2026	First draft

Policy 16 — Payment Services and Payment Methods

Operator	[COMPANY NAME], trading as PlayStake
Owner	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], Head of Compliance
Version	0.1 — draft for licence application
Review	Annually; before adding any payment method or provider; on any change to a provider's authorisation
Relates to	Gambling Commission requirement (in force 31 January 2024) that payments involving payment services are accepted only through a payment service provider as defined in the Payment Services Regulations 2017 (PSRs) — LCCP paragraph to be confirmed; LCCP 15.2.1 key events (change of key supplier); Documents 08, 13

> Draft prepared from the platform as built on 30 September 2026. `[BRACKETS]` must be completed, and each provider's authorisation checked on the FCA Financial Services Register, before submission.

1. Requirement

Where a payment to or from a customer involves a payment service, PlayStake may only accept or make it through a payment service provider (PSP) as defined in the PSRs: for example a bank, an authorised payment institution or an authorised electronic money institution. PlayStake does not provide payment services itself and does not accept payments in any other way.

2. How customers can pay us and be paid

Direction	Method	Provider	How it works
Deposit	Card (including Apple Pay and Google Pay, which are card payments)	Stripe	Card details are entered in Stripe's own payment form; Stripe processes the payment and tells PlayStake by signed webhook
Withdrawal	Payout to the customer's own bank account	Stripe (Connect Express)	The customer completes Stripe's onboarding once; PlayStake instructs Stripe to pay out

PlayStake does **not** accept cash, cheques, vouchers, cryptocurrency, direct bank transfers into its own account, payments from third parties, or any method not listed above.

3. Payment service provider register

Provider	Role	Authorisation	Status
Stripe Payments UK Ltd	Card acquiring and payouts for UK customers	FCA-authorised electronic money institution, FRN [900461 — confirm on the FCA register]	Integrated; running in **test mode**

Provider	Role	Authorisation	Status
Stripe Payments Europe Ltd	Card acquiring for EEA customers, if ever served	Authorised by the Central Bank of Ireland	Not used for UK customers
[ANY FUTURE PSP]			

Stripe and gambling. Stripe treats gambling as a restricted business that needs its prior written approval. Live processing must not start until Stripe has approved PlayStake's model in writing. If it does not, a PSP that supports licensed gambling must be appointed through §5 before launch.

4. How the platform enforces this

Control	Where
The payment methods PlayStake accepts are fixed in code (`card` only). Deposits send this list to Stripe, so a method switched on in the Stripe Dashboard — buy-now-pay-later, crypto, bank redirects — can never be offered to a customer without a code change and review.	`APPROVED_PAYMENT_METHOD_TYPES`, `src/lib/payments/policy.ts`; `createPaymentIntent`, `src/lib/payments/stripe.ts`
A second check when a deposit is confirmed: if a payment used anything other than an approved method, it is **not** credited, the transaction is marked failed, and staff are alerted to refund it.	`handlePaymentIntentSucceeded`, `src/app/api/webhooks/stripe/route.ts`
Money can only enter a customer balance from the `STRIPE_SOURCE` system account after a signature-verified Stripe webhook, and only leave to `STRIPE_SINK` through a Stripe payout. There is no staff tool, script or other route that credits or debits a balance from outside.	`src/lib/ledger/transfer.ts` and its callers
Live payments are refused unless explicitly enabled; today only a Stripe test key is accepted.	`assertTestPaymentsEnabled`, `src/lib/payments/policy.ts`
Automated tests check the approved list and that deposits pin it.	`tests/unit/payments/payment-methods.test.ts`

Moving stakes between customers' balances inside PlayStake (into escrow and out to the winner) is done on PlayStake's own ledger and involves no external payment.

5. Adding a payment method or provider

Nothing is added until every step is complete and recorded:

1. Confirm on the FCA register that the provider is a PSP under the PSRs for the service it will provide, and record the firm reference number and date checked.
2. Get the provider's written approval for licensed gambling.
3. Confirm the method is not a credit product (gambling on credit cards and similar credit is prohibited in Great Britain).
4. Assess AML and fraud risk (Policy 07) and how the payer's name will be matched to the verified customer.
5. Sign the contract and data processing agreement.

6. Add the method to `APPROVED_PAYMENT_METHOD_TYPES` through a Standard change (Document 11 §5), with tests.
7. Update this register and the outsourcing map (Document 08).
8. Consider whether it is a key event to notify (Document 14).

6. Ongoing checks

- **Annually**, and whenever we hear of a change, re-check each provider on the FCA register and record the result here.
- **Quarterly**, check the Stripe Dashboard's payment method settings match §2 (the code overrides them, but a mismatch shows someone tried to change them).
- If a provider loses its authorisation, stop taking payments through it at once and treat it as a Severity 2 incident (Document 14).

7. Open points

#	Point	Owner
1	Obtain Stripe's written approval for gambling, or appoint a gambling-approved PSP	Head of Compliance
2	Confirm the Stripe entity and FRN on the FCA register	Head of Compliance
3	**Block credit cards.** The approved method is "card", which includes credit cards. Before launch, refuse credit-funded cards (for example a Stripe Radar rule blocking `card_funding = credit`, with a server-side check on the payment method's funding type)	Head of Compliance / engineering
4	Switch currency from USD to GBP for UK customers	Engineering
5	Take legal advice confirming that moving stakes between customer balances on PlayStake's own ledger is not itself a regulated payment service	Head of Compliance

Version	Date	Change
0.1	30 September 2026	First draft